INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-53072E
09 May 2013
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-53072D
20 December 2010

DETAIL SPECIFICATION

CHEMICAL AGENT RESISTANT COATING (CARC) SYSTEM APPLICATION PROCEDURES AND QUALITY CONTROL INSPECTION



Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to: Director, U.S. Army Research Laboratory, Weapons and Materials Research Directorate, Materials Manufacturing Technology Branch, Specifications and Standards Office, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-D, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5069 or emailed to richard.j.squillacioti.civ@mail.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil/.

AMSC N/A FSC 8010

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CONTENTS

PARAGRAPH		PAGE
1.	SCOPE	1
1.1	Scope	1
2.	APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS	1
2.1	General	1
2.2	Government documents	1
2.2.1	Specifications, standards, and handbooks	1
2.2.2	Other Government documents, drawings, and publications	2
2.3	Non-Government publications	2
2.4	Order of precedence	4
3.	REQUIREMENTS	4
3.1	Definition	4
3.2	Cleaning	5
3.2.1	Abrasive blasting of ferrous metal surfaces	5
3.2.1.1	Exemptions from abrasive blasting	6
3.2.1.2	Vehicles	6
3.2.2	Zinc surfaces	6
3.2.3	Aluminum and aluminum-alloy surfaces	6
3.2.4	Magnesium alloy surfaces	7
3.2.5	Cadmium surfaces	7
3.3	Pretreating	7
3.3.1	Ferrous metal, zinc or cadmium surfaces	7
3.3.1.1	Organic pretreatments	7
3.3.2	Aluminum surfaces	7
3.3.3	Magnesium alloy surfaces	8
3.3.4	Wood surfaces	8
3.3.5	Stainless steel surfaces	8
3.3.6	Blasted steel armor	9
3.4	Priming	9
3.4.1	MIL-PRF-23377 (Primer Coatings: Epoxy, High-Solids)	10
3.4.1.1	Description	10
3.4.1.2	Use	11
3.4.1.3	Preparation	11
3.4.1.4	Reduction	11
3.4.1.5	Application	11
3.4.1.6	Comments	11
3.4.2	MIL-DTL-53022 (Primer, Epoxy Coating, Corrosion Inhibiting Lead and Chromate Free)	11
3.4.2.1	Description	11
3.4.2.2	Use	12
3.4.2.3	Preparation	12
3.4.2.4	Reduction	12
3.4.2.4.1	Type II primer	12
3.4.2.4.2	Type III and IV primers	12
3.4.2.5	Application	12
3.4.2.6	Comments	12
3.4.3	MIL-DTL-53030 (Primer Coating, Epoxy, Water Based, Lead and Chromate Free)	12
3.4.3.1	Description	12

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CONTENTS

PARAGRAPH		PAGE
3.4.3.2	Use	13
3.4.3.3	Preparation	13
3.4.3.4	Reduction	13
3.4.3.5	Application	13
3.4.3.6	Comments	13
3.4.4	MIL-DTL-53084 (Primer, Cathodic Electrodeposition, Chemical Agent Resistant)	13
3.4.4.1	Description	13
3.4.4.2	Use	13
3.4.4.3	Preparation	13
3.4.4.4	Reduction	14
3.4.4.5	Application	14
3.4.4.6	Comments	14
3.4.5	MIL-PRF-85582 (Primer Coatings: Epoxy, Waterborne)	14
3.4.5.1	Description	14
3.4.5.2	Use	14
3.4.5.3	Preparation	14
3.4.5.4	Reduction	14
3.4.5.5	Application	15
3.4.5.6	Comments	15
3.4.6	A-A-59745 (Zinc-Rich Coatings)	15
3.4.6.1	Description	15
3.4.6.2	Use	15
3.4.6.3	Preparation	15
3.4.6.4	Reduction	15
3.4.6.5	Application	16
3.4.6.6	Comments	16
3.4.7	MIL-PRF-32348 (Powder Coating, Camouflage, Chemical Agen6 Resistant Systems)	16
3.4.7.1	Description	16
3.4.7.2	Use	16
3.4.7.3	Preparation	16
3.4.7.4	Reduction	16
3.4.7.5	Application	16
3.4.7.6	Comments	17
3.5	Topcoating	17
3.5.1	MIL-DTL-53039 (Coating, Aliphatic Polyurethane, Single Component7 Chemical Agent Resistant)	17
3.5.1.1	Description	17
3.5.1.2	Use	17
3.5.1.3	Preparation	18
3.5.1.4	Reduction	19
3.5.1.5	Application	19
3.5.1.6	Comments	20
3.5.2	MIL-DTL-64159 (Camouflage Coating, Water Dispersible Aliphatic Polyurethane, Chemical Agent Resistant)	20
3.5.2.1	Description	20
3.5.2.2	Use	20
3.5.2.3	Preparation	20
3.5.2.4	Reduction	21

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CONTENTS

PARAGRAPH		PAGE
3.5.2.5	Application……..	21
3.5.2.6	Comments……	21
3.5.3	MIL-PRF-22750 (Coating, Epoxy, High-Solids)……	21
3.5.3.1	Description……	21
3.5.3.2	Use…….	21
3.5.3.3	Preparation…….	22
3.5.3.4	Reduction……	22
3.5.3.5	Application……..	22
3.5.3.6	Comments……	22
3.5.4	MIL-PRF-32348 (Powder Coating, Camouflage, Chemical Agent Resistant Systems)……..	23
3.6	Touch up and repair……	23
3.6.1	Surface preparation……	23
3.6.2	Repair procedures.....	23
3.6.2.1	Primer…….....	23
3.6.2.2	CARC topcoat……..	23
3.6.2.3	Application methods…….	24
3.6.2.4	Dry film thickness……..	24
3.7	CARC process notes……	24
3.7.1	HAP-free thinner……	25
3.8	Miscellaneous requirements……..	25
3.8.1	Camouflage (exterior)……	26
3.8.2	Surfaces not requiring paint……	26
3.8.3	Engines and other heated areas……..	26
3.8.4	Sealing……	26
3.8.5	Electrical components…….	26
3.8.6	Aluminum alloys and components……	26
3.8.7	Use of steel wool……	26
3.8.8	Welding, soldering and brazing…….	26
3.8.9	Handling and storage…….	27
3.8.9.1	Shelf life……	27
3.8.9.2	Heat, light moisture……	27
4.	VERIFICATION……...	27
4.1	Inspection conditions…….	27
4.2	Examination……	27
4.2.1	Test specimens……	27
4.2.2	Pre-production test surfaces……..	27
4.2.3	Coating validation……..	28
4.2.3.1	Application validation.....	29
4.2.3.1.1	Condition of surface……	29
4.2.3.2	Solvent wipe……..	29
4.2.3.3	Dry film thickness……	30
4.2.3.4	Marring……	31
4.2.3.5	Camouflage requirements and batch validation……	32
4.2.3.6	Adhesion…….	33
4.2.3.6.1	Dry adhesion……	33
4.2.3.6.2	Force dry of CARC Topcoat……..	33
4.2.3.7	Corrosion resistance……..	34
4.2.3.7.1	Non-ferrous substrates……..	34
4.2.3.8	Workmanship…….....	34

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CONTENTS

PARAGRAPH		PAGE
5.	PACKAGING	34
5.1	Packaging	34
6.	NOTES	34
6.1	Intended use	35
6.2	Acquisition requirements	35
6.3	Color chips	35
6.4	Qualifying activity responsibility	35
6.5	Experimental program	35
6.6	Coating characteristics	36
6.7	Touch-up kits	36
6.8	New heavy metal free pretreatments	36
6.9	HAP-free solvent specification	37
6.10	Subject term (key word) listing	37

TABLE		PAGE
I	The CARC system	5
II	General application guidelines for epoxy primers	10
III	Application characteristics for CARC topcoats	19
IV	Examination	29
V	Dry film thickness (mils)	32
VI	Coating characteristics	36

CONCLUDING MATERIAL ... 38

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers the requirements for application and inspection of the CARC systems used on military equipment. It is required for use in the selection process of the appropriate materials and procedures for the surfaces to be painted, and provides additional application, inspection, and quality control information for the below referenced cleaning, pretreating, and coating specifications. This document does not alleviate the need for proper consideration of corrosion prevention and control (e.g., material selection, system design, manufacturing processes, maintenance and other considerations during vehicle development and maintenance).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3, 4, or 5 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3, 4, or 5 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS

TT-P-28	- Paint, Aluminum, Heat Resisting.
TT-C-490	- Chemical Conversion Coatings And Pretreatments For Metallic Substrates (Base for Organic Coatings).

FEDERAL STANDARDS

FED-STD-595	- Colors Used in Government Procurement.
FED-STD-595/17925	- Miscellaneous, Gloss.
FED-STD-595/24533	- Green, Semigloss.
FED-STD-595/26307	- Gray, Semigloss.
FED-STD-595/ Color Chip Numbers	- 30051, 33446, 34031, 34094, 37030, 37031, 37038. All colors are flat or lusterless.

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTIONS

A-A-59503	- Nitrogen, Technical
A-A-59745	- Zinc-Rich Coatings

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MIL-DTL-5541	- Chemical Conversion Coatings on Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys.
MIL-C-8514	- Coating Compound, Metal Pretreatment, Resin-Acid.
MIL-A-8625	- Anodic Coatings for Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys.
MIL-DTL-12468	- Decontaminating Agent, STB.
MIL-PRF-14105	- Paint, Heat-Resisting (for Steel Surfaces).
DOD-P-15328	- Primer (Wash), Pretreatment (Formula No. 117 for Metals) (Metric).
MIL-A-18455	- Argon, Technical
MIL-PRF-22750	- Coating, Epoxy, High-Solids.
MIL-PRF-23377	- Primer Coatings: Epoxy, High-Solids.
MIL-PRF-32348	- Powder Coating, Camouflage Chemical Agent Resistant Systems.
MIL-DTL-53022	- Primer, Epoxy Coating, Corrosion Inhibiting Lead and Chromate Free.
MIL-DTL-53030	- Primer Coating, Epoxy, Water Based, Lead and Chromate Free.
MIL-DTL-53039	- Coating, Aliphatic Polyurethane, Single Component, Chemical Agent Resistant.
MIL-DTL-53084	- Primer, Cathodic Electrodeposition, Chemical Agent Resistant.
MIL-DTL-64159	- Camouflage Coating, Water Dispersible Aliphatic Polyurethane, Chemical Agent Resistant.
MIL-DTL-81706	- Chemical Conversion Materials for Coating Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys
MIL-T-81772	- Thinner, Aircraft Coating.
MIL-PRF-85582	- Primer Coatings: Epoxy, Waterborne.

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://assist.dla.mil/quicksearch or from the Standardization Document Order Desk, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.2.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

Department of the Army Technical Bulletin

TB-43-0242	- WD CARC Spot Painting (3 December 2007)

(Copies of this document are available online at https://www.logsa.army.mil/etmpdf/files/080000/084390.pdf or from USAMC Logistics Support Activity, Redstone Arsenal, AL 35898-7465.)

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

ASTM INTERNATIONAL

ASTM A380	- Standard Practice for Cleaning, Descaling, and Passivation of

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Stainless Steel Parts, Equipment, and Systems. (DoD adopted)

ASTM B117 - Standard Practice for Operating Salt Spray (Fog) Apparatus. (DoD adopted)

ASTM B244 - Standard Test Method for Measurement of Thickness of Anodic Coatings on Aluminum and of Other Nonconductive Coatings on Nonmagnetic Basis Metals with Eddy-Current Instruments. (DoD adopted)

ASTM B499 - Standard Test Method for Measurement of Coating Thicknesses by the Magnetic Method: Non-Magnetic Coatings on Magnetic Basis Metals. (DoD adopted)

ASTM D610 - Standard Practice for Evaluating Degree of Rusting on Painted Steel Surfaces. (DoD adopted)

ASTM D1193 - Standard Specification for Reagent Water. (DoD adopted)

ASTM D1640 - Standard Test Methods for Drying, Curing, or Film Formation of Organic Coatings at Room Temperature. (DoD adopted)

ASTM D1654 - Standard Test Method for Evaluation of Painted or Coated Specimens Subjected to Corrosive Environments. (DoD adopted)

ASTM D3330/ D3330M - Standard Test Method for Peel Adhesion of Pressure Sensitive Tape. (DoD adopted)

ASTM D3359 - Standard Test Methods for Measuring Adhesion by Tape Test.

ASTM D5895 - Standard Test Methods for Evaluating Drying or Curing During Film Formation of Organic Coatings Using Mechanical Recorders.

(Copies of these documents are available from www.astm.org or ASTM International, 100 Barr Harbor Drive, PO Box C700, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.)

GENERAL MOTORS ENGINEERING STANDARDS

GMW 14872 - Cyclic Corrosion Laboratory Test

(Copies of this document are available from www.ihs.com or General Motors International, General Motors Technical Center. Warren, MI 48092.)

AMERICAN WOOD PROTECTION ASSOCIATION (AWPA)

AWPA-T1 - Processing and Treatment Standard.

AWPA-P5 - Standard for Waterborne Preservatives.

(Copies of these documents are available from www.awpa.com/shop/index.asp or American Wood Protection Association, P.O. Box 361784, Birmingham, AL 35236.)

SAE INTERNATIONAL

AMS-QQ-P-416 - Plating, Cadmium (Electrodeposited). (DoD adopted)

AMS-M-3171 - Magnesium Alloy, Processes for Pretreatment and Prevention of Corrosion On. (DoD adopted)

(Copies of these documents are available from www.sae.org/servlets/index or SAE World Headquarters, 400 Commonwealth Drive, Warrendale, PA 15096-0001.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

SOUTH COAST AIR QUALITY MANAGEMENT DISTRICT
Rule 102 - Definition of Terms.
Rule 1107 - Coating of Metal Parts and Products.

(Copies of these documents are available from www.aqmd.gov/aqmd/Interfaces/onsiteservices.html or South Coast Air Quality Management District, 21865 Copley Drive, Diamond Bar, CA 91765.)

SSPC: THE SOCIETY FOR PROTECTIVE COATINGS

SSPC-SP2	- Hand Tool Cleaning.
SSPC-SP3	- Power Tool Cleaning.
SSPC-SP5/NACE No. 1	- White Metal Blast Cleaning.
SSPC-SP10/NACE No. 2	- Near White Blast Cleaning.

(Copies of these documents are available from www.sspc.org or SSPC: The Society for Protective Coatings, 40 24th Street, 6th Floor, Pittsburgh, PA 15222-4656.)

2.4 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Definition. Application of the CARC system consists of four distinct steps, each of which is critical to the performance of the overall system. The steps are cleaning, pretreating, priming, and topcoating. To ensure of CARC system adhesion, all pretreatment chemical reactions shall be complete prior to applying primer and topcoat. The anticorrosive primers are primarily epoxies and the topcoats are polyurethanes for exterior surfaces and an epoxy for interior surfaces. All of the coatings in the CARC system are Qualified Products Database (QPD) items, except for the zinc-rich coatings conforming to Commercial Item Description (CID) A-A-59745. There is a list of suppliers and products known to meet the salient characteristics of the CID. For the pretreatment coatings, refer to TT-C-490 for the various types and those that require QPD. In addition, each batch of polyurethane topcoat shall be checked by the specification's qualifying activity for validation of the spectral and specular reflectance (camouflage properties) and Super Tropical Bleach (STB) resistance. The STB composition shall be in accordance with MIL-DTL-12468. The local safety office, preventative medicine activity, and local medical support facility shall be consulted prior to applying the CARC system. For miscellaneous requirements, see section 3.8. Pertinent CARC material specifications are listed in table I. The choice of the coating system belongs to the government and this document is not intended to allow users to circumvent the system specified in the system requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. The CARC system.

Process	Ferrous Metal	Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys
Cleaning	TT-C-490	MIL-DTL-5541 / TT-C-490
Pretreating	TT-C-490, type I zinc phosphate and pretreatments for ferrous substrates qualified to types III, IV, and VIII, class A or C DOD-P-15328 (wash primer) MIL-C-8514 (wash primer)	DOD-P-15328 (wash primer) MIL-C-8514 (wash primer) MIL-DTL-5541/MIL-DTL-81706 (chemical conversion) 1/ MIL-A-8625 (anodize) TT-C-490 pretreatments for aluminum substrates qualified to types III, IV, and VIII, class B or C
Priming	A-A-59745 MIL-DTL-53022 MIL-DTL-53030 MIL-DTL-53084 MIL-PRF-23377, type I and II, class N 3/ MIL-PRF-32348, type I and II	MIL-PRF-23377, type I and II, class N2/ MIL-DTL-53022 MIL-DTL-53030 MIL-DTL-53084 MIL-PRF-85582, type I and II, class N2/ MIL-PRF-32348, type I and II
Topcoating	MIL-PRF-22750 (interior only) MIL-DTL-53039 MIL-DTL-64159 MIL-PRF-32348, type III and IV	MIL-PRF-22750 (interior only) MIL-DTL-53039 MIL-DTL-64159 MIL-PRF-32348, type III and IV

1/ Use of type II conversion coating (non-hexavalent chromium) preferred, if approved for application.

2/ The use of MIL-PRF-23377 and MIL-PRF-85582, Class N primers are approved for the exterior of aviation assets. For the interior of aviation assets, class C shall be used.

3/ May be used for mixed metal applications. Specific approval shall be obtained for use on ferrous substrates.

3.2 Cleaning. Meticulous cleaning prior to pretreatment and painting operations is critical to meeting the requirements of this specification. Improperly cleaned surfaces can interfere with paint film formation and adhesion, which can cause paint defects and premature paint peeling during service. Unless otherwise specified, surfaces shall be cleaned according to TT-C-490. Surface oxides, rust, weld spatter, oil, grease and all other organic and inorganic contaminants shall be removed prior to pretreatment. The cleaning method shall be determined by the base material properties, the nature of the soil(s), the degree of contamination and the part geometry. The following TT-C-490 methods shall be used singly or in combination to produce a clean surface:

a. Method I Mechanical or abrasive blast cleaning, sanding and grinding.
b. Method II Solvent cleaning by immersion, spray, vapor or hand wiping.
c. Method III Detergent cleaning by immersion, spray, ultrasonic, hot alkaline or electrolytic methods.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

d. Method IV Emulsion cleaning, with or without added water.
e. Method V Derusting by chemical means.
f. Method VI Phosphoric acid cleaner (detergent or solvent type with detergent)
g. Method VII Steam cleaning, with or without assisted pressure washing.

After cleaning, all surfaces shall be kept free from dirt, dust, finger marks, and other contaminants until treated as specified. If the CARC system cannot be applied immediately after cleaning, then the parts shall be protected from flash rusting and from contamination. Prior to applying the CARC system, the parts shall be re-inspected and cleaned, as required, and pass the water break test (see 4.2.3.1.1).

3.2.1 Abrasive blasting of ferrous metal surfaces. Unless otherwise specified, ferrous metal surfaces to be painted shall be cleaned in accordance with 3.2. If abrasive blasting is used to remove mill scale, products of corrosion, dirt, casting sand, slag and other foreign substances, then follow the procedure in the Society for Protective Coatings specification SSPC-SP5/NACE No. 1 or SSPC-SP10/NACE No. 2, unless otherwise specified. Abrasive blasting shall always be preceded by cleaning methods most appropriate for the application to assure the substrate is water-break free clean. Using clean water, for example, distilled, deionized, Reverse Osmosis (RO) purified or filtered water in an atomizing sprayer works well in this method for determining the results as described in 4.2.3.1.1. The blast media and maintenance of the abrasive blasting system shall be such that a consistent surface profile is maintained throughout the process and subsequent abrasive blast cleaning. Surface profile measurements shall not exceed the recommended range for the coating system applied and is recommended to be 1.0±0.5 mils, unless specified by the coating manufacturer so as to maintain the performance for coating adhesion and corrosion resistance. Ferrous media or media contaminated with ferrous spoils from previous abrasive blasting shall not be used on non-ferrous metallic substrates. Blast cleaned surfaces shall be coated within four hours with a suitable wash primer or other approved pretreatment material. Applied wash primer shall be dried for at least one hour at a preferred temperature range of 60 to 90 ºF (16 to 32 ºC). If more than four hours pass before pretreatment, the blasted surface shall be inspected and found free of corrosion or foreign matter, and pass the water break test (see 4.2.3.1.1) prior to pretreatment and priming. When the use of hexavalent chromium is restricted by contractual requirements, TT-C-490, type I, qualified pretreatments to TT-C-490, types III, IV, and VIII, class A or C or zinc-rich primers conforming to A-A-59745 shall be used as the alternatives on blasted ferrous substrates. Approval from the contracting officer shall be received prior to use of zinc-rich primers on blasted ferrous substrates. The requirement for primer dry film thickness (see 4.2.3.3) over a blasted profile is based upon film build over the peaks of the surface profile.

3.2.1.1 Exemptions from abrasive blasting. Abrasive blasting shall not be used on surfaces that could be damaged, such as machine parts and sheet metal thinner than 16 gauge (0.0625 inches or 1.5875 mm). Blasting is optional, on components painted for protection during limited storage, where the paint wears off as soon as the equipment is placed in use. Component examples are track assemblies, track roller assemblies (including mounting frames), interiors of weld-type box sections, bulldozer components (including rippers, scarifiers, ejectors, push plates, blades, bowls, and buckets), scrapers and crane shovels, interiors of cement mixer drums, and interiors of aggregate driers. However, these surfaces shall be cleaned using one of the methods described in 3.2 and shall be free from oil, grease, dirt, and rust. All surfaces shall be dry prior to

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

painting.

3.2.1.2 Vehicles. Ferrous metal surfaces of vehicles shall be cleaned for painting in accordance with 3.2.1, except as specified herein. Surfaces that cannot be cleaned by blasting shall be cleaned to base metal by alternate means such as three dimensional/abrasive cleaning, chipping, powered wire brushing, or grinding to the required degree specified for commercial abrasive blasting, if authorized by the contracting agency. Sheet metal and sheet metal parts of 8 gage (0.164 inches or 4.166 mm) and thinner shall be cleaned to bare metal by acid pickling in accordance with TT-C-490, with a maximum of five percent sulfuric acid included. However, chemical cleaning shall not be approved for use on assemblies which entrap acid/alkali or when for any reason chemical cleaning is considered inadvisable. Wire brushes used to clean ferrous surfaces shall be either steel or stainless steel. Brass brushes shall not be used, as there is a possibility of depositing brass particles on the steel surface, potentially accelerating corrosion of steel surfaces. Hand tool cleaning shall be in accordance with SSPC-SP2 and power tool cleaning shall be in accordance with SSPC-SP3.

3.2.2 Zinc surfaces. Zinc surfaces, including zinc-coated substrates, shall be cleaned and activated prior to being pretreated for painting as specified in 3.3.

3.2.3 Aluminum and aluminum-alloy surfaces. Aluminum and aluminum alloys shall be cleaned in accordance with 3.2, followed immediately by treatment as specified in 3.3. Aluminum thicker than 1/8th inch and fabricated from 5000 series armor grade aluminum shall be abrasive blasted.

3.2.4 Magnesium alloy surfaces. Magnesium alloy surfaces shall be cleaned in accordance with SAE-AMS-M-3171, followed immediately by treatment as specified in 3.3.

3.2.5 Cadmium surfaces. Cadmium surfaces shall be cleaned in accordance with SAE-AMS-QQ-P-416, followed immediately by treatment as specified in 3.3.

3.3 Pretreating. Chemical surface treatments for metallic substrates provide improved adhesion for subsequent coatings and temporary protection from corrosion. For best results, the pretreatment shall be applied as soon as possible after proper cleaning (see 3.2). The three most common pretreatments are chromate/chromium, phosphate and organic-modified conversion coatings.

3.3.1 Ferrous metal, zinc or cadmium surfaces. These surfaces shall be treated as soon as possible after cleaning as specified in 3.2 with one of the following:

a. Zinc phosphate conforming to TT-C-490, type I.
b. Wash primer (DOD-P-15328 and MIL-C-8514) conforming to TT-C-490, type III.
c. Pretreatments qualified under TT-C-490, including organic and inorganic pretreatments and pre-primer coatings conforming to types III, IV and VIII, class A or C.

3.3.1.1 Organic pretreatments (Wash Primer). The organic pretreatments in 3.3.1 b are applied to clean metal surfaces to prepare for a more permanent protective anticorrosive primer. Although wash primers afford some protection for up to 24 hours, they are not intended for permanent protection and these surfaces shall be overcoated with epoxy primer as soon as practical, however no more than 24 hours after wash primer application. After more than 24

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

hours following application, the wash primer shall be stripped and the finishing process started again. The pretreatment is sufficiently dry for priming one hour after application under preferred atmospheric conditions of 60 to 90 ºF (16 to 32 ºC). The pretreatment shall not be applied to visibly wet surfaces or where the surface temperature is less than 50°F (10°C). The dry film thickness shall be 0.3 to 0.5 mils (7.5 to 12.5 microns). To prepare DOD-P-15328, the resin component shall be stirred or agitated to ensure that all solids content are completely dispersed. The acid component shall be added slowly with stirring, continuing until a complete blending of the mixture is achieved. The pretreatment material is then ready for use. If the resin component is thickened or gelled, do not add the acid component until fluidity has been restored. This can be achieved by warming up the resin component. The pretreatment is most effective when freshly mixed and shall be used within 8 hours after the addition of the acid component. The quantity of the pretreatment mixed for use shall be the amount required for immediate application. The acid component is not a thinner. It is a necessary activator and shall be used exactly as directed by the manufacturer. When thinning is required for spray application, follow the manufacturers' recommendations.

3.3.2 Aluminum surfaces. Aluminum surfaces shall be treated as soon as possible after cleaning as specified in 3.2 with one of the following:

a. Anodized aluminum and aluminum alloy castings in accordance with MIL-A-8625. Minimum thickness of 0.0007 inches (.018 mm) is required for wrought aluminum and 0.0004 inches (.010 mm) is required for castings.
b. Chemical conversion conforming to MIL-DTL-5541.
c. Wash primer conforming to DOD-P-15328 or MIL-C-8514.
d. Pretreatments qualified under TT-C-490, including organic and inorganic pretreatments and pre-primer coatings conforming to types III, IV and VIII, class B or C.

3.3.3 Magnesium alloy surfaces. Prior to painting, magnesium alloy surfaces shall be treated in accordance with SAE-AMS-M-3171, type I or III, or DOD-P-15328 with half of the specified phosphoric acid. Treated surfaces that become scratched in handling shall be touched up in accordance with SAE-AMS-M-3171, type I. To maintain a system that is free of hexavalent chromium, MIL-DTL-5541, type II or commercial product recommended by the manufacturer and approved by the Program Manager shall be used. For approved products based upon memorandums, contact US Army Research Laboratory, RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005.

3.3.4 Wood surfaces. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), wood shall be pressure treated and marked in conformance with AWPA-T1 for above ground, or AWPA-P5 for ground contact installations. Wood shall be dried to the specified moisture content appropriate for the size, species, and ultimate service conditions, but in no case greater than 20 percent. Wood painted with CARC shall first be sealed with a polyurethane-based wood sealer.

3.3.5 Stainless steel surfaces. These surfaces shall be treated as soon as possible after cleaning as specified in 3.2 or by one of the alternative methods described in ASTM A380 if the surface is still active. Abrasive blasting shall be specified prior to application of a wash primer conforming to DOD-P-15328 or MIL-C-8514 (see 3.3.1 b and 3.3.1.1). Where wash primer is not allowable, a minimum of a 0.5 mil profile shall be achieved using aluminum oxide or other non-ferrous abrasive blasting media prior to painting.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.6 Blasted steel armor. On blasted ferrous armor substrates that have Rockwell C hardness (HRC) greater than 39, wash primer containing phosphoric acid shall not be used. This is due to the risk of hydrogen embrittlement from the phosphoric acid in the component B of the wash primer. In lieu of wash primer, TT-C-490, type I, qualified pretreatments to TT-C-490 types III and IV not containing phosphoric acid or zinc-rich primer conforming to A-A-59745 shall be used as the pretreatment. Refer to 3.2.1, abrasive blasting of ferrous metal surfaces, for alternatives to hexavalent chromium containing pretreatments. For blasted ferrous substrates greater than HRC 42, prior approval from the contracting officer shall be received before zinc-rich primers are used as an alternative. Refer to TT-C-490 for embrittlement testing and stress relief for steel alloys at Rockwell C hardness (HRC) 39 or greater. Applying Zinc-rich primer to ferrous substrates with a hardness rating greater than HRC 42, is prohibited unless the contractor submits a request for deviation and receives approval.

3.4 Priming. The primer shall be applied to a clean, dry surface within 24 hours of cleaning and pretreating. The preferred temperature range for the application of these primers shall be 60 to 90 ºF (16 to 32 ºC). If priming is done outside of this range, then all quality control checks shall be done (see 4.2.3) to verify film integrity. The paint and surface shall be approximately the same temperature and not less than 50°F (10°C). When surface temperature or air temperature is < 5 ºF above dew point, the coating is adversely affected. At relative humidity in excess of 50%, a dew point calculation may be necessary to avoid the formation of moisture on the substrate to be coated. Application shall be by brush or spray, depositing a continuous, adherent film which is smooth, uniform, and free from runs, sags, or other defects that might interfere with the application and adhesion of subsequent coatings (see 4.2.3.8). The film thickness requirement of each primer is specified in table V. If paint heaters are used to assist in application, the substrate to be coated shall be at least an ambient temperature of 60 ºF (16 ºC). Dipcoating is not a recommended application method for CARC primers. The anticorrosive primers are primarily epoxies and two component products. The powder coating primers are epoxies, but are one component materials. The zinc- rich primers are either two component epoxies or one component moisture cured urethanes. They are applied to metal substrates to provide corrosion resistance and a surface to which the CARC coating system firmly adheres. The two component products dry by a two stage process of solvent evaporation and chemical crosslinking, and they have a finite potlife, typically 6-8 hours. Environmental conditions, particularly temperature and relative humidity, can affect potlife, curing, and adhesion. In areas where air quality regulations restrict volatile emissions, do not add thinner to the coating material if that addition exceeds the regulatory limit. If thinner needs to be added, consult with the manufacturer of the primer for the appropriate thinner to stay within the regulatory limits. The specific information below for the seven primers is summarized in table II. If a contract requires the use of zinc-rich primer, then MIL-DTL-53022 or MIL-DTL-53030 shall be applied over the zinc-rich primer as a barrier coat between the zinc-rich primer and the topcoat. In addition to the liquid primers, there is also an epoxy anticorrosive powder coating primer (MIL-PRF-32348) that can be used in the CARC paint system. When a contract specifies the use of either MIL-DTL-53022 or MIL-DTL-53030, alternative primers MIL-DTL-53084 or MIL-PRF-32348 are authorized for use only with the approval of the contracting officer.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. General application guidelines for epoxy primers. [1/] [2/]

Specification	Mixing	Reduction	Application
MIL-PRF-23377	Slowly add component B to component A. Preferred temperature range 60 to 90 °F (16 to 32 ºC) prior to mixing as specified by the manufacturer.	Stir and strain. Set 30 minutes before use, unless induction time is not required, per manufacturer's instructions.	Spray with one full coat. Wait 4-6 hours prior to topcoating. Use within 8 hours. Apply at a dry film thickness (DFT) of 0.8-1.2 mils. [3/]
MIL-PRF-32348, type I and II	Follow the instructions from the manufacturer for preparation and application.	Reduction does not apply, since these products are powder coatings and do not use solvents.	Follow the instructions from the manufacturer.
MIL-DTL-53022	One part component B to four parts component A. Add B to A. Preferred temperature range 60 to 90 °F (16 to 32 ºC) prior to mixing.	If necessary and allowed, reduce types III and IV with a VOHAP-free thinner, as specified in 3.7.1, or supplied by the manufacturer, not to exceed VOC limits where applicable. Type II primer may also be thinned with MIL-T-81772, types I or II. Stir and strain. Set 30 minutes before use or as recommended by manufacturer.	Spray with one full coat. Wait 30-60 minutes prior to topcoating. Use within 4-6 hours for type II, III and IV. DFT: 1.5 ± 0.2 mils.
MIL-DTL-53030	Mix component A until uniform. One part component B with three parts component A for type I and 1 part component B to 4 parts component A for type II. Add B to A. Preferred temperature range 60 to 90 oF (16 to 32 ºC).	Using deionized water, reduce according to manufacturers' instructions. Use mechanical mixer and add water slowly. Mix and strain. Stir 30 minutes before use.	Spray with one full coat. Wait 30-60 minutes before topcoating. Use within 6 hours. DFT: 1.5 ± 0.2 mils. High humidity retards dry, low humidity accelerates dry. Make sure surface is free of water prior to topcoating.
MIL-DTL-53084	Follow the manufacturers' instructions.	Reduce with very pure deionized water.	Follow the instructions from the manufacturer.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. General application guidelines for epoxy primers. - Continued

A-A-59745	Mix and agitate pigmented component thoroughly. Mix as specified by the manufacturer. Preferred temperature range 60 to 90 °F (16 to 32 °C) prior to mixing.	Reduce, if necessary, by manufacturers' specifications. Set 30 minutes before use for epoxy type.	Dry times and recoat times based upon manufacturers' specifications. Protect moisture cure from moisture for extended potlife. Epoxy type use within 4-6 hours. DFT: 2.5-3.5 dry mils. The use of an agitator pressure pot is recommended.
MIL-PRF-85582	Thoroughly mix component A. Slowly add component B to component A as specified by the manufacturer. Preferred temperature range 60 to 90 °F (16 to 32 °C) prior to mixing.	Use deionized water. Stir and strain. Set 30 minutes before use.	Spray with one full coat. Wait 30-60 minutes prior to topcoating or based upon manufacturers' recommendations. Use within 4 hours. DFT: 0.8-1.2 mils.3/ Apply at 60-100 °F (16-38 °C). High humidity retards dry, low humidity accelerates dry. Make sure surface is free of water prior to topcoating.

1/ Always add component B to component A, never in reverse.
2/ Time duration prior to topcoating are based on 70 °F (21 °C) ambient temperature. At 60 °F, doubling the time is necessary to get adequate curing for topcoating.
3/ DFT for aluminum-steel assemblies. If aluminum only, 0.6 - 0.9 mil DFT is acceptable.

TERMS: 1 mil = 25 microns.

3.4.1 MIL-PRF-23377 (Primer Coatings: Epoxy, High-Solids).

3.4.1.1 Description. This specification covers the requirements for corrosion inhibiting, chemical and solvent resistant, solvent-borne, epoxy primer coatings that have a maximum volatile organic compound (VOC) content of 340 grams/liter (g/l) (2.8 pounds/gallon (lbs/gal)). The specification contains formulations that allow for standard pigments (type I) and low infrared reflective pigments (type II). It also differentiates between two classification systems, class C and class N. Class C contains either barium chromate or strontium chromate based corrosion inhibitors and class N contains non-chromate based corrosion inhibitors.

3.4.1.2 Use. This primer is intended for use on pretreated aluminum alloy surfaces as a corrosion inhibitive, chemical resistant primer. It is compatible with CARC topcoats. Type II shall not be used as a CARC primer, except on aircraft, and where specifically required (see 6.6).

3.4.1.3 Preparation. Thoroughly mix and stir component A prior to admixing. While slowly pouring component B into component A, continue to stir until the manufacturer's specified volume mixing ratio is achieved. Each component shall be properly metered to assure correct

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

mixing ratios. Reduction of the admixed material shall be according to the manufacturers' instructions. Component B shall always be added to component A and this procedure shall never be reversed. The preferred temperature range of each component shall be 60 to 90 °F (16 to 32 °C) before mixing.

3.4.1.4 Reduction. Reduce the admixed primer if necessary with MIL-T-81772 type II, HAP-free thinner (see 3.7.1) or thinner recommended by the manufacturer, but do not exceed the VOC limit of 340 g/l (2.8 lbs/gal). The reduced primer shall be continuously stirred to allow thorough mixing and to counter pigment settling. Strain through a 60 mesh minimum paint filter or equivalent. Let stand at room temperature for 30 minutes to allow primer adequate time to induct or follow the manufacturers' instructions.

3.4.1.5 Application. All surfaces to be painted shall be thoroughly cleaned as specified in 3.2 and pretreated as specified in 3.3. To ensure a chemically clean surface, perform the test in 4.2.3.1.1. Failure to comply with 4.2.3.1.1 is sufficient cause to do additional cleaning. The primer shall be applied to the specified film thickness and needs to dry up to 6 hours (dry to touch) before applying the topcoat. Times vary depending upon environmental conditions and the manufacturers' recommendations. The admixed primer shall be used within 4 hours after mixing to ensure performance. The dry film thickness (DFT) shall be between 0.6 and 0.9 mils (15 and 22.5 microns) for aluminum and between 0.8 and 1.2 mils (20 and 30 microns) for aluminum-steel assemblies. The largest factor affecting cure is temperature. At 70 °F (21 °C), the dry to touch time is 30 minutes and the surface is dry to handle within 6 hours when checked according to ASTM D1640.

3.4.1.6 Comments. The primer furnished under this specification shall be products that are authorized by the qualifying activity for listing in the QPD (see 6.4).

3.4.2 MIL-DTL-53022 (Primer, Epoxy Coating, Corrosion Inhibiting, Lead and Chromate Free).

3.4.2.1 Description. This specification covers an air drying, corrosion inhibiting epoxy primer for ferrous and nonferrous metals. It is formulated lead and chromate free. The type II coating has a maximum VOC content of 420 g/l (3.5 lbs/gal). Type III and IV coatings are hazardous air pollutants-free (HAP-free) and have a maximum VOC content of 340 g/l (2.8 lb/gal). Type IV is also an enhanced corrosion performance technology. The enhanced corrosion performance includes 1,000 hours salt spray and 40 cycles on the cyclic corrosion test. A type V coating is furnished in self-contained portable kits. The kits contain the type IV corrosion inhibiting epoxy primer in a touch-up system. The specification is a two package system consisting of a pigmented epoxy resin (component A) and a polyamine-epoxy catalyst (component B).

3.4.2.2 Use. This primer is intended for use on properly cleaned and pretreated ferrous and nonferrous surfaces. It is an acceptable primer system to use with CARC topcoats.

3.4.2.3 Preparation. The component A shall be thoroughly mixed and stirred prior to admixing. Mix one part of component B to four parts of component A by volume and stir until well blended. Allow the admixed material to sit according to the manufacturer's recommended induction time. The preferred temperature range of each component shall be 60 to 90 °F (16 to 32 °C) before mixing.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.2.4 Reduction.

3.4.2.4.1 Type II primer. If necessary and allowed, the admixed primer shall be reduced for spraying up to 20 percent by volume with HAP-free thinner (see 3.7.1), thinner recommended by the manufacturer or MIL-T-81772, type I or II.

3.4.2.4.2 Type III and IV primers. The type III and IV primers shall use only HAP-free solvents that are approved by the Army Research Laboratory (see 3.7.1) or recommended by the manufacturer to maintain the HAP-free material for application. The thinned primer shall be thoroughly stirred, strained through a 60 mesh minimum paint filter or equivalent and allowed to sit according to the manufacturer's recommended induction time prior to use and shall continue to be stirred throughout the primer application. Mechanically mixing with an air agitator shortens the induction time. Consult with manufacturer for reduced induction time.

3.4.2.5 Application. All surfaces to be painted shall be thoroughly cleaned as specified in 3.2 and pretreated as specified in 3.3. To ensure a chemically clean surface, perform the test in 4.2.3.1.1. Failure to comply with 4.2.3.1.1 is sufficient cause to do additional cleaning. After completion of the 30 minute induction period, when required, the primer shall be sprayed to achieve a DFT of 1.5 ± 0.2 mils (37.5 ± 5 microns). The primer needs only to be dry to touch at these film thicknesses before applying the topcoat. This is usually between 30 and 60 minutes in accordance with ASTM D5895, depending on conditions. Type II, III and IV material shall be used within 4-6 hours. Potlife is shortened at higher temperatures. The largest factor affecting cure is temperature. At 70 ^{o}F (21 ºC**)**, the dry to touch time is between 30-60 minutes. Dry to handle time is 90 minutes to 4 hours depending on the coating type. The use of plural component metering spray equipment, if approved by the manufacturer, eliminates the requirement to have an induction period of the mixed primer before application and also eliminates potlife constraints.

3.4.2.6 Comments. The primer furnished under the specification shall be products which are authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the QPD (see 6.4).

3.4.3 MIL-DTL-53030 (Primer Coating, Epoxy, Water Based, Lead and Chromate Free).

3.4.3.1 Description. This primer is a water based, air-drying, corrosion inhibiting epoxy primer. It is a two component system with a pigmented polyamide (component A) and a clear to milky epoxy catalyst (component B). The primer is formulated HAP-free, lead and chromate free and contains no more than 340 g/l (2.8 lbs/gal) VOC as applied, in accordance with Rule 1107 of the South Coast Air Quality Management District. The primer is furnished in coating types II and III. Type II is enhanced corrosion performance, water dispersible technology. The enhanced corrosion performance includes 1,000 hours salt spray and 40 cycles on the cyclic corrosion test. Type III is self contained portable kits. The kits contain the type II coating epoxy primer in a touch-up system.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.3.2 Use. The primer is intended for use on pretreated ferrous and nonferrous substrates and is compatible with CARC topcoats. The MIL-DTL-53030 epoxy primer shall not be applied directly to wash primer containing phosphoric acid, such as those conforming to DOD-P-15328 or MIL-C-8514. Other pretreatments, as referenced in 3.3, are acceptable.

3.4.3.3 Preparation. Thoroughly agitate and mix component A until uniform. If necessary, use a paint shaker to disperse any settled pigment in component A. Mix one volume of component B with four volumes of component A for a type II coating until a smooth homogeneous mixture is achieved. The preferred temperature range of each component shall be 60 to 90 °F (16 to 32 ºC) before mixing. Component B shall be added to component A under constant agitation.

3.4.3.4 Reduction. Reduce the admixed primer with deionized water conforming to ASTM D1193 type IV, or according to manufacturers' recommendations. Water shall be added under constant agitation. The thinned primer shall be strained through a 60 mesh minimum paint filter or equivalent and allowed to stand for 30 minutes prior to use or according to manufacturers' recommendations. Mechanical mixing shortens the induction time. Consult with the manufacturer for these times.

3.4.3.5 Application. All surfaces to be painted shall be thoroughly cleaned as specified in 3.2 and properly pretreated as specified in 3.3. To ensure a chemically clean surface, perform the test in 4.2.3.1.1. Failure to comply with 4.2.3.1.1 is sufficient cause to do additional cleaning. After completion of the 30 minute induction period, the primer shall be sprayed to achieve a DFT of 1.5 ± 0.2 mils (37.5 ± 5 microns). The primer needs only be dry to touch (ASTM D5895) before applying the topcoat. This is usually between 30 to 60 minutes depending on conditions. The admixed primer shall be used within 6 hours to ensure performance. The largest factor affecting cure is temperature. At 70 °F (21 ºC), the dry to touch time is 30 to 60 minutes and the dry to handle time about 2 hours. Due to the fact that the primer is a water based system, a high relative humidity retards the dry time while a low relative humidity accelerates the process. Temperature increase shortens potlife.

3.4.3.6 Comments. The primer furnished under this specification shall be a product authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the QPD (see 6.4). Since the sprayed primer contains water, care shall be taken to ensure that the primer surface is dry to touch before application of MIL-DTL-53039. Premature topcoating leads to compromised CARC properties.

3.4.4 MIL-DTL-53084 (Primer, Cathodic Electrodeposition, Chemical Agent Resistant).

3.4.4.1 Description. This primer is a waterborne, cathodic epoxy electrodeposition primer formulated lead and hexavalent chrome free. It meets solvent emission maximums of 144 g/l (1.2 lbs/gal) VOC.

3.4.4.2 Use. This primer is intended for use on properly cleaned and pretreated ferrous and nonferrous metal surfaces and is compatible with CARC topcoats. Since it is applied with an immersion-type procedure and cured by baking, this primer is designed for a large-scale production process.

3.4.4.3 Preparation. The manufacturer shall provide instructions for mixing and thinning. Prepare the primer bath by mixing resin feed and pigment paste components, or single-

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

component blended feed with pure deionized water that is free of bacteria (conductivity less than 10 microhms/centimeter). After mixing components allow bath to be stirred and agitated for at least a one (1) hour period to facilitate thorough mixing and reduction.

3.4.4.4 Reduction. After preparation of the bath, allow it to stir for at least one hour prior to use. Continuous agitation, even while coating, is necessary after preparation to maintain homogeneity of the diluted electrodeposition primer bath.

3.4.4.5 Application. All surfaces to be painted shall be thoroughly cleaned as specified in 3.2 and pretreated as specified in 3.3. To ensure a chemically clean surface, perform the test in 4.2.3.1.1. Failure to comply with 4.2.3.1.1 is sufficient cause to do additional cleaning. Since the primer is applied via cathodic electrodeposition, the substrate to be coated is the negative electrode, while the side electrodes are positive. Coat and cure as recommended by the coating manufacturers' instructions.

3.4.4.6 Comments. The primer furnished under this specification shall be products which are authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the QPD (see 6.4). If a black electrocoat primer is used, the minimum topcoat dry film thickness shall be 2 mils (50 microns) to ensure the infrared reflectance (IR) signature requirements of the topcoat are met. In production situations where abrasive cleaning or grit-blasting is used to remove mill scale, the profile of the metal shall be no greater than 1 mil (25 microns). To achieve the required 1,000 hour salt spray resistance on ferrous substrates, the electrodeposition primer DFT shall be equal to or greater than the average blasted profile of the substrate. The proposed system of blasting, pretreatment and priming shall be checked for compliance to MIL-DTL-53084, paragraph 3.6.7.

3.4.5 MIL-PRF-85582 (Primer Coatings: Epoxy, Waterborne).

3.4.5.1 Description. This specification covers the requirements for corrosion inhibiting, chemical and solvent resistant, waterborne, epoxy primer coatings that meet a maximum VOC of 340 g/l (2.8 lbs/gal). The specification contains formulations that allow for standard pigments (type I) and low infrared reflective pigments (type II). It also differentiates between systems with barium chromate (class C1), strontium chromate (class C2) and non-chromate (class N) based corrosion inhibitors.

3.4.5.2 Use. The primer is intended for use on pretreated nonferrous substrates and is compatible with CARC topcoats. Type II shall not be used as a CARC primer, except on aircraft, and where specifically required (see 6.6).

3.4.5.3 Preparation. The epoxy primer shall be prepared by first thoroughly mixing or agitating component A. Component A is the pigmented base component of epoxy resin solution, and component B is the curing agent. The two components are then mixed in the volume ratio specified by the manufacturer. The preferred temperature range of each component shall be 60 to 90 ^{o}F (16 to 32 ^{o}C) before mixing.

3.4.5.4 Reduction. Reduce the admixed primer with deionized water conforming to ASTM D1193 type IV, or according to the manufacturer's recommended procedure. The thinned primer shall be stirred thoroughly, strained through a 60 minimum mesh paint filter or equivalent and allowed to stand for 30 minutes prior to use. Continuously stir the reduced primer throughout the

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

coating application.

3.4.5.5 Application. All surfaces to be painted shall be thoroughly cleaned as specified in 3.2 and properly pretreated as specified in 3.3. To ensure a chemically clean surface, perform the test in 4.2.3.1.1. Failure to comply with 4.2.3.1.1 is sufficient cause to do additional cleaning. After completion of the 30 minute induction period, the primer shall be sprayed to achieve a DFT between 0.6 and 0.9 mils (15 and 22.5 microns) for aluminum and between 0.8 and 1.2 mils (20 and 30 microns) for aluminum-steel assemblies. The primer needs only be dry to touch conforming to ASTM D5895 before applying the topcoat. This is usually between 30 minutes and 1 hour depending on conditions. The admixed primer shall be used within 4 hours to ensure performance. The largest factor affecting cure is temperature. At 70 °F (21 ºC**)**, the dry to touch time is within one hour and the primer is dry to handle within 6 hours. The effect of decreasing the temperature within a facility's painting area doubles the cure time for each 18 degree F (10 degree C) drop in temperature under 70 °F (21 ºC**)**. Due to the fact that this is a water-reducible system, a high relative humidity retards the cure time while a low relative humidity accelerates the process.

3.4.5.6 Comments. The primer furnished under this specification shall be products which are authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the QPD (see 6.4). Since the sprayed primer contains water, care shall be taken to ensure the surface is dry to touch before application of urethane topcoats. Premature topcoating leads to an undesirable reaction between the water evaporating from the primer and the catalyst component of the urethane being applied.

3.4.6 A-A-59745 (Zinc-Rich Coatings).

3.4.6.1 Description. These VOC compliant, zinc-rich coatings are designed for direct application to blasted ferrous surfaces in place of other pretreatments. These coatings are either two component epoxies or single component moisture cured polyurethanes. These coatings shall contain a minimum of 90% by weight of zinc dust pigment in their dried films and conform to Commercial Item Description (CID) A-A-59745, Zinc-Rich Coatings. The zinc-rich coatings shall be subsequently overcoated only with MIL-DTL-53022 or MIL-DTL-53030 prior to the application of the CARC topcoat at a minimum DFT of 1 mil (25 microns). These zinc-rich coatings shall meet a VOC content no greater than 420 g/l (3.5 lbs/gal).

3.4.6.2 Use. These primers coatings are designed for enhanced corrosion resistance providing cathodic protection and self healing properties. These products shall be used with CARC. Epoxy primer MIL-DTL-53022 or MIL-DTL-53030 shall be applied at a minimum of 1.0 dry mils (25 microns) as a barrier coat between the zinc-rich primer and the CARC topcoat.

3.4.6.3 Preparation. The pigment portion of the coating shall be thoroughly mixed prior to use or admixing. Follow instructions specified by the manufacturer. Constant agitation shall be used during application to prevent settling of the zinc pigment. The moisture cured type is a single component and does not require any admixing. The epoxy two component types shall be mixed following the manufacturers' specifications.

3.4.6.4 Reduction. If necessary and allowed due to environmental regulations, the zinc-rich coating shall be reduced according to the manufacturer's recommended procedure. The single component, moisture cured zinc-rich coating does not require any induction time, but the 2

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

component epoxy type requires a 30 minute induction time.

3.4.6.5 Application. All surfaces to be painted shall be thoroughly cleaned as specified in 3.2. The zinc-rich coating shall be applied directly to blasted ferrous metal for maximum performance. The coating shall be sprayed to achieve a dry film thickness no less than 2.5 dry mils (62.5 microns) or as recommended by the manufacturer. If not specified, the recommended DFT range is between 2.5 - 3.5 mils (62.5 - 87.5 microns). Dry times and recoat times are as specified by the manufacturer. The pot life of the moisture cured urethane type is unlimited, if kept free from moisture contamination. The pot life of the epoxy types is 4 - 6 hours at 70 ºF (21 ºC).

3.4.6.6 Comments. For approved zinc-rich coatings to be used on Army tactical equipment, contact the U.S. Army Research Laboratory (ARL), ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Building 4600, Deer Creek Loop, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5066.

3.4.7 MIL-PRF-32348 (Powder Coating, Camouflage, Chemical Agent Resistant Systems.

3.4.7.1 Description. This specification covers powder coatings for use on metallic substrates as an anticorrosive primer with CARC topcoats, as well as a camouflage and non-camouflage CARC topcoat for use as a finish coat on military combats equipment. Type I is a corrosion inhibiting epoxy primer for ferrous and nonferrous metals. For interior application, the type II powder primer can be used to replace the two coat system of epoxy primer and MIL-PRF-22750 topcoat. The powder primer shall have prior approval from ARL in the specific topcoat color. The type III powder covers camouflage CARC for use as finish coats on military equipment. The type IV powder covers ammunition container CARC. These can be used on all tactical military equipment, which includes ground, aviation, and related support assets. Because powder coatings do not require solvents, these coatings shall be VOC-free and volatile organic hazardous air pollutant-free (VOHAP-free).

3.4.7.2 Use. The type I and II powder primers are intended for use on properly cleaned (see 3.2) and pretreated (see 3.3) ferrous and nonferrous metal surfaces. Wash primer conforming to DOD-P-15328 or MIL-C-8514 shall not be used as a pretreatment when applying powder primers. These powder primers are formulated lead and chromate free and are compatible with all CARC topcoats. The type III powder coating is applied over approved type I powder primers. The type IV powder coating is applied directly to properly cleaned and pretreated metal. Since these products are electrostatically applied and requires baking for cure, this primer is designed primarily for small and component parts. Parts shall be evaluated for their ability to withstand the baking temperatures required in accordance with the manufacturers' recommendations prior to coating.

3.4.7.3 Preparation. The manufacturer shall provide instructions for application preparation.

3.4.7.4 Reduction. Since this is a powder coating and does not use solvent, reduction does not apply.

3.4.7.5 Application. All surfaces shall be properly cleaned and pretreated before application to steel, aluminum or other substrates. The powder coatings are applied and cured using the powder coat process specified by the manufacturer. This is generally an electrostatic application of the powder material, where the part is electrically connected to an earth ground and the powder is

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

positively or negatively charged during application. Be sure to read and follow all safety instructions provided by the manufacturer with the powder equipment to avoid injuries associated with electrical current flow.

3.4.7.6 Comments. The primers and topcoats furnished under this specification shall be products which are authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the QPD. The powder coatings shall be stored under environmentally controlled conditions having a maximum temperature of 80 ^{o}F (27 ^{o}C) and maximum humidity of 50%. The coatings in storage shall be kept away from direct sunlight.

3.5 Topcoating. The four CARC topcoats provide chemical agent resistance and color for the system. In addition, the polyurethanes (exterior surfaces) provide camouflage, durability and survivability properties. The epoxy (interior surfaces) provides a smooth, easily-cleaned surface which is resistant to wear. These coatings also offer improved performance and prolonged service life. It is best to apply the topcoat to a freshly primed substrate within 24 hours. Application of the topcoat shall occur within the minimum time allowed (specified by the primer material) and a maximum of 168 hours after the primer application or as specified by the manufacturer of the primer. Dipcoating is not recommended for the CARC topcoats (see 3.4). If topcoating proceeds after 168 hours, either scuff sanding followed by a solvent wipe or a primer mist coat is required (see 4.2.3.2). Adhesion testing (see 4.2.3.6) shall be used to monitor intercoat adhesion. As with CARC primers, application shall be by brush or spray, the paint and substrate shall be approximately the same temperature, and ambient temperature shall be between 60 and 90 ^{o}F (16 and 32 ^{o}C) at application and for a period of time after application sufficient to assure adequate cure prior to exposure to adverse conditions. When surface temperature or air temperature is < 5 ^{o}F above dew point, the coating is adversely affected. At relative humidity in excess of 50%, a dew point calculation may be necessary to avoid the formation of moisture on the substrate to be coated. In areas where air quality regulations restrict volatile emissions, do not add thinner to the coating material if that addition exceeds the regulatory limit. Environmentally acceptable solvents or solvent blends shall be used for reduction. The specific information below for the different topcoats is summarized in table III.

3.5.1 MIL-DTL-53039 (Coating, Aliphatic Polyurethane, Single Component, Chemical Agent Resistant).

3.5.1.1 Description. This specification covers both camouflage and non-camouflage, chemical agent resistant, aliphatic polyurethane coatings for use as finish coats on military combat equipment. It is a single component, moisture cured finish which is lead and chromate (hexavalent) free, and has VOC ranging from 0 - 420 g/l (0 - 3.5 lbs/gal) depending upon the type of coating as packaged. This specification only encompasses formulations that are flattened with polymeric flattening agents. Each type has VOHAP-free formulations.

3.5.1.2 Use. MIL-DTL-53039 is intended for all tactical and support equipment. It can be applied over any of the anticorrosive primers described in 3.4, or to a CARC basecoat which is at least dry to touch, as in camouflage pattern painting, or aged and thoroughly cleaned, as in rework. If rework takes place, the previous paint finish shall be scuff sanded and cleaned prior to this coating being applied. It shall not be applied over an existing alkyd or lacquer finish. As a camouflage topcoat, it shall be applied to exterior surfaces and interior surfaces routinely visible from the outside, such as door ramps and hatches.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.1.3 Preparation. Thoroughly mix by stirring or agitation to a smooth, homogeneous state. Care shall be exercised to redisperse any pigment which settles to the bottom of the container. Any package which shows evidence of grit, seeds, skins, abnormal thickening or excessive pigment settling shall not be used.

TABLE III. Application characteristics for CARC topcoats.

Specification	Mixing	Reduction	Application
MIL-DTL-53039	Stir or agitate until uniform. Paint containing grit, seeds, skins, abnormal thickening or excessive pigment settling shall not be used.	If necessary and allowed, reduce with a VOHAP-free thinner, as specified in 3.7.1, or supplied by the manufacturer, not to exceed VOC limits where applicable. Stir and strain.	Coating is water sensitive, so don't let water come into contact with the coating. High humidity accelerates dry and cure times, and promotes blistering. Once opened, use within 8 hours unless protected by a nitrogen or argon blanket[1/]. Apply a minimum DFT of 1.8 mils. Cure time increases with low temperature and low humidity, and decreases with higher temperature and higher humidity. At 70 ^{o}F (21 ^{o}C), the coating completely cures in one week.
MIL-DTL-64159	After component A is thoroughly stirred or agitated to redisperse settled pigments then add 1 part by volume of component B to 2 parts by volume of component A and mix well with a mechanical mixer	If necessary reduce to sprayable viscosity 3 parts by volume admix with up to 1 part by volume of water or in accordance with manufacturer's directive using a mechanical mixer. Stir and strain.	Use the admix coating within 6 hours. Apply a minimum DFT of 1.8 mils. Cure and dry time increases with low temp and high humidity, and decreases with higher temp and lower humidity. At 70 ^{o}F (21 ^{o}C), the coating completely cures in one week.
MIL-PRF-32348, type III and IV [2/]	Follow the instructions from the manufacturer for preparation and application.	Reduction does not apply, since these products are powder coatings and do not use solvents.	Follow the instructions from the manufacturer.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III. Application characteristics for CARC topcoats. - Continued.

MIL-PRF-22750	Component A shall be thoroughly mixed. Component B shall be added to component A as specified by the manufacturer.	If necessary and allowed, reduce types II and III coatings with a VOHAP-free thinner, as specified in 3.7.1, or supplied by the manufacturer, not to exceed VOC limits where applicable. Type I coating may also be reduced with MIL-T-81772, types I or II. Stir and strain. Let stand 30 minutes.	Apply in one or two coats, as specified by the manufacturer, to a total DFT between 1.7 - 2.3 mils. Use within 8 hours. At 70 ^{o}F (21 ^{o}C), the coating completely cures in one week.

1/ See 3.5.1.5 for nitrogen and argon requirements
2/ MIL-PRF-32348 is both a primer and CARC topcoat specification. Refer to section 3.4.7.

TERMS: 1 mil = 25 microns.

3.5.1.4 Reduction. If necessary for spray application and allowed by VOC regulations, reduce MIL-DTL-53039 with thinner specified in 3.7.1, thinner recommended by the manufacturer or MIL-T-81772, type I to a maximum ratio of four parts by volume of the coating to one part by volume of the solvent. To maintain a VOHAP-free material upon application, use thinner approved by the Army Research Laboratory (see 3.7.1) or follow the manufacturers' recommendations for thinning. MIL-DTL-53039 (except colors Aircraft Green, 34031 and Interior Aircraft Black, 37031) shall be strained through a paint filter to remove any impurities. Thinning is not necessary for brush application, however, for spray application, the coating can be reduced as described above, if required. MIL-T-81772, type II solvent shall never be used with this CARC topcoat, as it affects the curing of this coating.

3.5.1.5 Application. For adequate camouflage properties, it is necessary to apply the coating to a minimum DFT of 1.8 mils (45 microns). Under certain temperature and humidity conditions, for more even results, apply two coats of a minimum DFT of 0.9 mils (22.5 microns) each. The coating is moisture sensitive and caution shall be taken to ensure water does not come in contact with the coating at any time, especially with a compressed air source. High humidity conditions shorten the dry and cure times, and may cause blistering. Under high humidity conditions, the DFT shall be kept at about 2 mils (50 microns) to minimize blistering. Once opened, MIL-DTL-53039 shall be used within eight hours unless stored in a pressure pot or container under a dry, oil free nitrogen or argon blanket, or in a sealed dry air/airless container. The nitrogen shall conform to A-A-59503, type I, grade A, class I and the argon shall conform to MIL-A-18455, type I. At temperatures of 70 ^{o}F (21 ^{o}C) and above, MIL-DTL-53039 dries within the specification requirements in accordance with ASTM D5895 (dry to touch in approximately 15 minutes, dry hard in three hours, dry through in four hours, with a complete cure within seven days). At 52 ^{o}F (11 ^{o}C), MIL-DTL-53039 requires twice as long to cure. Do not apply to items attaining temperatures in excess of 400 ^{o}F (204 ^{o}C), such as manifolds, exhaust pipes, or mufflers. Use MIL-PRF-14105 or TT-P-28, as applicable. Do not apply MIL-DTL-53039 to a

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

surface which is contaminated with moisture.

3.5.1.6 Comments. MIL-DTL-53039 is a QPD item, and procurement shall be from an approved supplier. In addition, there is a batch validation requirement which specifies that a sample from every batch shall be approved for visible and near infrared reflectance properties (see 6.4). This coating, when applied as packaged or reduced with exempt solvent, is suitable where VOC regulations limit solvent emissions to 420 g/l (3.5 lbs/gal) or lower. To avert undesirable reactions, spray lines used for epoxy paints shall not be used for polyurethanes without complete flushing and cleaning with solvents. All lines and hoses shall be blown dry following cleaning and flushing to ensure that there is no adverse reaction with potential moisture or solvents in the lines. MIL-DTL-53039 is often applied under camouflage pattern painting (CPP) guidelines in 3-color patterns containing Green 383, 34094, Brown 383, 30051, and Black, 37030. In desert applications, Tan 686A, 33446 is available. For further information on patterns, contact ARL, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Building 4600, Deer Creek Loop, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5066.

3.5.2 MIL-DTL-64159 (Camouflage Coating, Water Dispersible Aliphatic Polyurethane, Chemical Agent Resistant).

3.5.2.1 Description. This specification covers water-dispersible, chemical agent resistant, aliphatic polyurethane coatings for use as a finish coat on all tactical military equipment, which includes ground, aviation and related support assets. The materials are VOHAP-free, free of inorganic HAPS, other than cobalt and non-hexavalent chromium, and have a maximum VOC content of 220 g/l (1.8 lbs/gal) as packaged. The material is available in two coating types. Type II contains polymeric flattening pigments. Type III is furnished in self contained portable kits. The kits contain the type II CARC in a touch-up system.

3.5.2.2 Use. MIL-DTL-64159 coatings are intended for all tactical and support equipment. It can be applied over any of the primers listed in table I and described under 3.4, or to a CARC basecoat which is at least dry to touch, as in camouflage pattern painting, or to a completely cured and thoroughly cleaned existing finish, as in rework. If rework takes place, the previous paint finish shall be scuff sanded and cleaned prior to this coating being applied. It shall not be applied over an existing alkyd or lacquer finish. Substrates and regulatory requirements determine which epoxy primer is to be selected as the undercoat for this CARC application.

3.5.2.3 Preparation. The material is furnished in two components. Component A consists of a hydroxyl functional polyurethane dispersion that is formulated with prime and extender pigments, additives and solvents. Component B consists of an aliphatic isocyanate prepolymer that is dispersible in water. The composition mixing ratio for the components is a two to one by volume mixing ratio of component A to component B. Component B is very water sensitive and caution shall be taken to ensure that water or high humidity does not come in contact with the component at any time prior to admix. Mix and agitate component A to fully disperse all pigments, and then add 1 part by volume of component B to 2 parts by volume of component A under constant agitation. Apply vigorous mechanical agitation to the combined components with a high shear mixer. The combined material shall be mixed for about 3 minutes with the high shear mixer. The admixed material noticeably thickens as it is being mixed. The mixer shall be a high speed air drill with a vortex cage mixer attachment. Do not hand mix or use a paint shaker to mix the two

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

components together.

3.5.2.4 Reduction. Reduce the coating by adding up to one part by volume of deionized water (ASTM D1193, type IV) to three parts by volume of the admix coating or as specified by the manufacturers' instructions for spray application. Reduction with water shall occur while the material is being mechanically agitated to ensure proper incorporation with the other components. The same equipment used to combine the two components shall be used during the addition of water phase. Do not over thin the admixed material.

3.5.2.5 Application. For adequate camouflage properties, it is necessary to apply the coating to a minimum DFT of 1.8 mils (45 microns). Under certain temperature and humidity conditions, for more even results, it is advisable to apply two coats of a minimum DFT of 0.9 mils (22.5 microns) each. Drying time increases with lower temperatures or higher humidity, and decreases with higher temperature or lower humidity. At temperatures of 70 ^{o}F (21 ^{o}C) and above, MIL-DTL - 64159 dries within the specification requirements in accordance with ASTM D5895 (dry to touch in approximately 60 minutes, dry hard in 6 hours, dry through in eight hours, with a complete cure within 7 days for type II). At 52 ^{o}F (11°C), MIL-DTL-64159 requires twice as long to cure. Do not apply MIL-DTL-64159 to a surface which is contaminated with moisture. Do not apply to items attaining temperatures in excess of 400 ^{o}F (204 ^{o}C), such as manifolds, exhaust pipes, or mufflers. Use MIL-PRF-14105 or TT-P-28, as applicable.

3.5.2.6 Comments. MIL-DTL-64159 is a QPD item, and procurement shall be from an approved supplier. In addition, there is a batch validation requirement which specifies that a sample from every batch shall be approved for specular and gloss reflection (see 6.4). This coating, when applied as packaged or reduced with water, is suitable where VOC regulations limit solvent emissions to 220 g/l (1.8 lbs/gal). To avert undesirable reactions, spray lines used for epoxy paints shall not be used for polyurethanes without complete flushing and cleaning with solvents. All lines and hoses shall be blown dry following cleaning and flushing to ensure that there is no adverse reaction with potential moisture or solvents in the lines. The spray lines shall also be flushed with water prior to application to remove any undesirable solvents in the lines. MIL-DTL-64159 is often applied under camouflage pattern painting (CPP) guidelines in 3-color patterns containing Green 383, 34094, Brown 383, 30051, and Black, 37030. In desert applications, Tan 686A, 33446 is available. For further information on patterns, contact ARL, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Building 4600, Deer Creek Loop, Aberdeen Proving Ground,
MD 21005-5066.

3.5.3 MIL-PRF-22750 (Coating, Epoxy, High-Solids).

3.5.3.1 Description. This specification covers the requirements for a two-component, high-solids epoxy coating with a maximum VOC content of 340 g/l (2.8 lbs/gal) and which is formulated to be free of cadmium, chromium and lead. A coating kit is available for use.

3.5.3.2 Use. MIL-PRF-22750 is intended to provide an interior topcoat for all tactical and support equipment. It can be applied over any of the primers described in 3.4, or to CARC basecoat which is at least dry to touch or which is completely cured and thoroughly cleaned, as in rework. If rework takes place, the previous paint finish shall be scuff sanded and cleaned prior to

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

this coating being applied. It shall not be applied over an existing alkyd or lacquer finish. Since epoxy-polyamide paint films are sensitive to ultraviolet radiation and tend to chalk upon exposure to sunlight, MIL-PRF-22750 shall be applied only to interior surfaces.

3.5.3.3 Preparation. Prior to combining the two components together, component A shall be thoroughly mixed by stirring or agitation to a smooth homogeneous state. Care shall be exercised to redisperse any pigment which settles to the bottom of the container. Material which contains evidence of pigment flotation, coarse particles, or objectionable settling, which cannot be readily dispersed, shall not be used. Components from different manufacturers shall not be mixed, nor shall components from different color kits be mixed. After combining the two components, the coating compound shall be thoroughly mixed into a smooth, homogeneous state. After combining the two components, the mixed material shall be allowed to sit for a 30 minute induction time. The use of plural metering spray equipment eliminates the requirement to have a 30 minute induction period of the mixed primer before application.

3.5.3.4 Reduction. If the type I admixed coating needs to be thinned for application, HAP-free thinner (see 3.7.1), thinner recommended by the manufacturer or solvent conforming to MIL-T-81772, type I or type II shall be used. The type II and III epoxy topcoats shall use only HAP-free solvents that are approved by the Army Research Laboratory (see 3.7.1) or recommended by the manufacturer to maintain the HAP-free material for application. Caution shall be taken when thinning so as not to exceed the maximum VOC content of 340 g/l (2.8 lbs/gal) in areas where air pollution regulations are enforced. The thinned paint shall be thoroughly stirred, strained through a 60 minimum mesh paint filter to remove any impurities, and allowed to stand at room temperature for 30 minutes before using.

3.5.3.5 Application. The application of the mixed coating shall be applied in one full coat to the required DFT 1.7 to 2.3 mils (42.5 to 57.5 microns) or two coats, each being about 1 mil (25 microns) DFT to help prevent blistering and gloss variations. Another option to help prevent bleeding, blistering or gloss variations is after completion of the 30 minute induction period, spray a mist coat of the MIL-PRF-22750 over the primer and allow to dry for 30 minutes. It shall be thin, discontinuous and translucent (not full hiding). Follow this step with a full wet coat to a DFT of 1.3 to 1.7 mils (32.5 to 42.5 microns). For aircraft, apply two coats to a total DFT of 2.0 to 2.4 mils (50 to 60 microns). Mixed coating shall be used within 8 hours. Pot life is shortened by higher temperatures. Curing time increases with lower temperature and decreases with higher temperature. At temperatures of 70 ^{o}F (21 ^{o}C) and above, MIL-PRF-22750 dries within specification requirements in accordance with ASTM D5895 (dry to touch in four hours, dry hard in eight hours, and complete cure in seven days).

3.5.3.6 Comments. MIL-PRF-22750 is a QPD item, and procurement shall be from an approved supplier. To avert undesirable reactions, spray lines used for both epoxy and polyurethane paints shall be completely flushed or thoroughly cleaned before switching. MIL-PRF-22750 is the CARC for interior surfaces. This coating is supplied in many colors referenced in FED-STD-595, such as color numbers 17925, 24533 and 26307. For further information contact ARL, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Building 4600, Deer Creek Loop, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5066.

3.5.4 MIL-PRF-32348 (Powder Coating, Camouflage, Chemical Agent Resistant Systems). For

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

description, use, preparation, reduction, application and comments for type III and IV topcoats, see 3.4.7

3.6 Touch up and repair. When touching up damaged areas or applying CARC topcoat to an existing CARC topcoat, the procedure to be followed depends upon the type and condition of the existing finish. Items previously coated with alkyds, lacquers or vinyls shall be stripped down to the epoxy primer if present, or to the substrate if not. For rework, polyurethane and epoxy topcoats shall only be applied over previously painted epoxy or polyurethane topcoats that are free of defects, deterioration and/or corrosion. If coating over existing epoxies or polyurethanes aged more than 168 hours, the surface shall be cleaned, scuff sanded, and solvent wiped.

3.6.1 Surface preparation. Scratches or other light damage to polyurethane or epoxy topcoats shall require scuff sanding at the immediate blemish area. Damage or corrosion extending to the substrate shall require sanding or abrasive blasting and repriming. All traces of corrosion shall be removed from the substrate. The surface immediately surrounding exposed substrate shall then be sanded, using a feathering-in technique which requires sanding away paint film (primer and topcoat) so that the thickness of the film is smoothly tapered from bare metal/substrate to the top of the paint film. An area around the tapered section shall be scuff sanded to allow for overcoating with a suitable CARC topcoat. Sanding of any type shall be followed by wiping down the exposed area to be painted using an environmentally acceptable procedure that removes all loose sanding debris, mill scale, grease, oil (including fingerprints), and diesel/gasoline residue. This procedure shall be performed in a well ventilated area while wearing gloves to prevent skin contact with cleaning solvents. Consult safety personnel to determine appropriate gloves and protective clothing, and to determine if respiratory protection is needed. All steel areas sanded down to bare metal shall be pretreated with wash primer DOD-P-15328, MIL-C-8514 or chromate free pretreatments qualified to TT-C-490. All aluminum areas sanded to bare metal shall be pretreated with wash pretreatment, DOD-P-15328 or MIL-DTL-5541, or chromate free pretreatments qualified to TT-C-490 and allowed to set for a minimum of 15 minutes. The minimum area allowed for touch-up shall be agreed upon for each contract between the Government and the applicator.

3.6.2 Repair procedures.

3.6.2.1 Primer. Choose the appropriate primer and prepare in accordance with 3.4. Apply evenly in one coat over the pretreated substrate and apply over portions of the exposed original primer coat using blend-in technique which is tapering off quantity applied to a thin edge.

3.6.2.2 CARC topcoat. Ensure that the surface to which the topcoat is applied is clean and dry. The surface temperature shall be between 60 ^{o}F (16 ^{o}C) and 90 ^{o}F (32 ^{o}C) at application and for a period of time after application sufficient to assure adequate cure prior to exposure to adverse conditions. Apply evenly to blend with the original surface around the area to be touched up using the blend-in technique (see 3.6.2.1). Allow epoxy primer to dry a minimum of 1 hour or until dry to touch before topcoating. For MIL-DTL-53030, all water shall evaporate prior to top-coating. If the primer has dried for more than 168 hours, it shall be lightly scuff sanded, and solvent wiped to promote adhesion. Application of CARC topcoats to surfaces previously painted with CARC (in repair of light topcoat damage) can proceed while the original coat is still tacky. Polyurethane, which has fully cured, shall be thoroughly cleaned, scuff sanded and solvent wiped prior to refinishing. Epoxy, which has fully cured, shall be cleaned, scuff sanded,

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

and solvent wiped prior to refinishing. The surface shall be thoroughly clean of absorbed/deposited carbon, salt, fuel, oil, hydraulic/transmission fluid fingerprints and wax. Scuff sand to remove any visible paint defects such as chalk, then solvent wipe prior to application of new topcoat. Do not apply CARC topcoats to surfaces subjected to temperatures in excess of 400 ^{o}F (204 ^{o}C), such as exhaust systems or turbochargers.

3.6.2.3 Application methods. Rework (application of CARC topcoats to sound existing topcoat) shall use the conventional techniques of spraying or brushing. For touchup, suggested procedures include brushing (see appropriate application section of primer and topcoat descriptions) or sponging/wiping (suggested for small areas requiring wash primer). Use good quality equipment with proper technique for spray application by conventional techniques. Small self-pressurized spray kits are also available for use in CARC touch-up procedures. Do not use spray cans that are not officially CARC, as specified in paragraph 2.2.2 of TB-43-0242, WD CARC Spot Painting, dated 3 December, 2007. There are a number of spray cans that are labeled for CARC touch-up. They are a visual color match to CARC, but they do not have CARC properties or approval. They shall not be used for CARC touch-up. The only touch-up kits that shall be used are those approved by ARL. They contain the appropriate CARC and they are supplied in various packaged forms such as spray cans, cartridges and touch-up kits. These products are supplied in both MIL-DTL-53039 and MIL-DTL-64159 and are listed in the QPD.

3.6.2.4 Dry film thickness. The total dry film thickness (DFT) of previous coatings shall be checked prior to reworking. Limitations on maximum DFT to be topcoated shall be determined by an adhesion test on the existing coating in accordance with 4.2.3.6. It is recommended not to exceed a total of 20 mils (500 microns). For aircraft, the coating DFT (existing plus rework) shall not exceed 8 mils (200 microns). The maximum DFT shall be 9 mils (225 microns) on a porous, cast item. If thicker prior coatings are experienced, adhesion failure and coating fissuring could result. Cracking (fissuring) of the topcoat due to too thick a film is subtle and difficult to find (magnification is often necessary) but is cause for rejection due to porosity and permeability.

3.7 CARC process notes.

a. Mix thoroughly. The 55 gallon drums supplied in closed head drums, which is normally the case for the MIL-DTL-53039, shall be put on a drum tumbler or drum roller for at least 6 hours before use. Other CARC supplied in open head drums shall be mixed using agitators. A paint shaker for smaller sized containers saves time and eliminates stirring with a paddle or mixer, which promotes moisture contamination and thus shortens the pot life.
b. Keep moisture away from MIL-DTL-53039 and from component B in MIL-DTL-64159, either by the use of very dry (-32°F(-36°C) dew point air dryer) air, desiccant air dryer on air line, or nitrogen or argon blanket.
c. Use a separate piece of equipment for epoxy primer and for the urethane topcoat, or thoroughly flush all lines used for both coatings when switching. Do a final flush with the solvent that is compatible with the CARC topcoat.
d. Clean equipment thoroughly and in accordance with manufacturers' instructions for use, and before prolonged storage.
e. Rotate inventory of material first in, first out. CARC has a one year shelf life.
f. Be sure to remove all thinner from coiled hoses and the pumping system before storage. Since thinner dries out pumping system gaskets, a good grade of

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

light oil such as automatic transmission fluid shall be used to prevent this occurrence.

g. When automated equipment such as robotics are used, be sure to use meter mixing equipment, strict viscosity control, material quality control, and total system supervision shall be maintained.
h. Store material in a clean, dry, temperature controlled, OSHA approved storage facility (see 3.8.9).
i. Insist on operator training in operation, maintenance and storage of equipment.
j. Do not use material directly from the container unless thoroughly agitated and mixed.
k. Do not apply the coating to a surface which is contaminated with moisture.
l. Do not allow thinner to stand in the material hoses. The epoxy and the polyurethane material residue reacts, even though thinner or solvent is present, and blocks up mixed material hoses.
m. Do not spray in unventilated areas without proper EPA and OSHA approved spray equipment. For appropriate equipment contact your environmental safety and health coordinator.
n. Do not spray epoxy primer or CARC on a dirty surface. Remove all surface rust, oil, dirt, and loose paint before applying epoxy primer or CARC.
o. Do not leave component A or B of polyurethane topcoat in air-operated pumps for more than two hours without recirculation.
p. To prevent solidification, do not leave mixed materials in hoses, cups, or pumps for longer than 2 hours when not in use, unless a recirculation system is used.
q. Use of commercially available chemical accelerators is strictly prohibited.
r. Where Aircraft Black, color # 37038, is specified for use, Black, color # 37030 is authorized to be used in its place.
s. The effects of decreasing temperature within a facility's painting area doubles the cure time for each 18 degree F (10 ºC) drop in temperature under 70 ^{o}F (21 ºC**)**.
t. A heated atmosphere accelerates cure time.
u. Induction time is after all components are added, including thinner, if needed.
v. Use of pot or cup agitation equipment is strongly encouraged to minimize the potential for the solids to settle during spraying application.

3.7.1 HAP-free thinner. The Army Research Laboratory (ARL) has developed a HAP-free, low VOC thinner blend to be used as an alternative to MIL-T-81772, types I and II with the solvent borne epoxy and polyurethane CARC coatings to maintain a HAP-free coating for application. This solvent blend consists of 75±2% T- Butyl Acetate and 25±2% Methyl Amyl Ketone. ARL has written a specification sheet (see 6.9) for this solvent blend and issued a memorandum to the Chemical Agent Resistant Coating Community approving the use of this solvent blend. For copies or list of suppliers, contact ARL, Weapons and Materials Research Directorate, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5066. The General Services Administration has issued the following NSN numbers for this solvent: 8010-01-608-8272 for 1-gallon containers, 8010-01-608-8271 for 5 gallon pails and 8010-01-608-8274 for 55 gallon drums. Each supplier shall provide a certificate of conformance and analysis with each shipment.

3.8 Miscellaneous requirements.

3.8.1 Camouflage (exterior). Unless otherwise specified, all material except aircraft shall have a base topcoat of the color Green 383, 34094 for the three color woodland pattern. The system

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

used shall be compatible with and provide good adhesion for subsequent coatings used to provide the camouflage pattern. Tan 686A, 33446 is the base coat for desert application and black CARC component parts shall be indicated on end item drawings or as specified in the contract. CARC shall be topcoated only with CARC.

3.8.2 Surfaces not requiring paint. Fabrics, plastics, rubber working parts of machinery, lubrication fittings and other surfaces not normally painted shall not be painted unless required by the specification for the end item. Such surfaces shall be masked or protected during treatment and painting to prevent damage to them. If the paint doesn't interfere with their function, protection is not required and overspray is allowed.

3.8.3 Engines and other heated areas. Engines shall be cleaned and treated as specified herein and painted in accordance with the applicable engine specification. When cleaning and painting of exhaust manifolds, exhaust pipes, mufflers, and other parts subject to high temperatures in excess of 400 ^{o}F (204 ^{o}C) is specified in the applicable engine specification, the paint shall conform to MIL-PRF-14105 or TT-P-28, as applicable.

3.8.4 Sealing. Unless otherwise specified in the end item specification, sealing of the interiors of gear cases or similar compartments and reservoirs shall be in accordance with the applicable sealant specification. The sealer shall be applied prior to assembly and shall withstand immersion in lubricating oil, hydraulic fluids, and cutting compounds for the operating temperatures and atmospheric conditions specified for the end item, without wrinkling, blistering, peeling, or loss of adhesion.

3.8.5 Electrical components. Electrical components of equipment not otherwise governed by applicable specifications shall be treated and painted in accordance with the contractor's standard practice.

3.8.6 Aluminum alloys and components. When an aluminum part, component or specimen is processed, the corrosion resistance test described for primer applied to steel specimens outlined in paragraph 4.2.3.7 is applicable, except the corrosion testing parameters for non-ferrous specimens shall be based upon the requirements specified for aluminum substrates in the appropriately specified primer specification. The frequency of testing shall be as specified in 4.2.3.7.

3.8.7 Use of steel wool. Steel wool shall not be used in lieu of emery or garnet abrasives to clean aluminum or magnesium alloy surfaces.

3.8.8 Welding, soldering and brazing. Unless otherwise specified, welding, soldering and brazing shall not be permitted on an assembly after it has been painted with CARC finishes. If necessary to perform one of these procedures after an item is coated, the finish shall be completely removed to the substrate at least four inches in all directions from the work area and in all areas that reach 400 ^{o}F (204 ^{o}C) and above, including the backside if it is CARC painted. A lesser radius for removal of the CARC system is practical provided that the weld or repair procedure can verify that the heat affected zone has not exceeded 250 ^{o} F (121° C). Three recommended methods for removal are the use of plastic media blasting at approximately 40 lb/in^{2} (2.812 kg/cm^{2}), the use of a suitable chemical paint remover or the use of a hand-held portable sander/grinder equipped with a wire brush. After the procedure is finished, the stripped

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

surfaces shall be cleaned, pretreated and repainted (see 3.6).

3.8.9 Handling and storage. Keep CARC components away from heat, sparks, and open flame. Store in tightly closed containers and protect from moisture and foreign materials. At maximum storage temperatures noted below, material slowly undergoes chemical changes without hazard and results in components not being usable. Although ideal storage temperature range is 70 - 75 ^{o}F (21 - 24 ^{o}C), normal storage temperature (min/max) of 32 - 122 ^{o}F (0 - 50 ^{o}C) shall be allowed. CARC components which are stored at temperatures below the minimum cited above are not degraded, but they shall be returned to usable temperature 60 - 90 ^{o}F (16 - 32 ^{o}C) before using. For powder coatings conforming to MIL-PRF-32348, refer to 3.4.7.6 for storage requirements. Guaranteed shelf life is 12 months from date of manufacture at 77 ^{o}F (25 ^{o}C).

3.8.9.1 Shelf life. If CARC is received from the GSA or through the supply system after the labeled shelf life expiration date, do not accept it. If a unit accepts CARC that is expired it shall submit a report of discrepancy (ROD) to the appropriate agency immediately. Contact the installation environmental office for guidance on proper disposal of expired materials.

3.8.9.2 Heat, light moisture. If container of material is exposed to heat, it can pressurize and burst. If moisture enters a container of MIL-DTL-53039 or component B of MIL-DTL-64159, the contents react to produce carbon dioxide, which results in pressure building up inside the container. Do not reseal if contamination is suspected. If the paint reaches minimum temperatures of 32 ^{o}F (0 ^{o}C) or below, it thickens however, upon rewarming it is usable. The temperature range specified 60 - 90 ^{o}F (16 - 32 ^{o}C) shall be attained throughout the paint before mixing and applying.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with test conditions specified in applicable test method document or applicable paragraph(s) in the specification.

4.2 Examination. The end item treatment and painting shall be examined for the defects specified in table IV.

4.2.1 Test specimens. Unless otherwise specified, test specimens shall be prepared from parts or pieces of parts, provided they are of the same metal as the manufactured parts and have been coated in the same manner at approximately the same time.

4.2.2 Pre-production test surfaces. Determine daily, prior to actual painting, the suitability of the coating mixes with prevailing application parameters such as atmospheric conditions, painting techniques and equipment, thinning and mixing ratios. Determine daily, prior to actual painting, the adequacy of production procedures and practice surfaces (with the specified pretreatment). Separate surfaces shall be prepared (coated) for each coating operation, that is pretreatment plus primer and pretreatment plus primer plus topcoat. Test surfaces either on actual steel parts or representative steel panels approximately 4 x 12 inches (10.16 x 30.48 cm) for each coating shall be prepared. Low carbon steel panels shall be substituted for metal parts which are not steel. These surfaces shall be coated with the 4 inch (10.16 cm) dimension positioned vertically and the 12 inch (30.48 cm) dimension positioned horizontally. They shall be observed for blushing,

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

sagging, blisters, improper wet film thickness or other in-process defects detectable during or shortly after application and appropriate adjustments/corrections made. The final successfully coated test surface used to validate each batch/block of production coating application shall be evaluated and recorded.

TABLE IV. Examination.

Item Number	Defect	Reference Paragraph
101	Cleaning not as specified.	3.2
102	Ferrous metal surfaces to be painted not prepared as specified.	3.2.1
103	Surfaces that are not components exempted from abrasive blasting not prepared for painting as specified.	3.2.1.1
104	Ferrous metal surfaces of vehicles not cleaned for painting as specified.	3.2.1.2
105	Zinc surfaces not cleaned as specified.	3.2.2
106	Aluminum surfaces not cleaned as specified.	3.2.3
107	Aluminum-alloy surfaces not cleaned as specified.	3.2.3
108	Magnesium alloy surfaces not cleaned as specified.	3.2.4
109	Cadmium surfaces not cleaned as specified.	3.2.5
110	Pretreatment not applied after cleaning as specified.	3.3
111	Ferrous metal surfaces not treated as specified.	3.3.1
112	Zinc surfaces not treated as specified.	3.3.1
113	Cadmium surfaces not treated as specified.	3.3.1
114	Aluminum surfaces not treated as specified.	3.3.2
115	Magnesium alloy surfaces not treated as specified.	3.3.3
116	Wood surfaces not treated as specified.	3.3.4
117	Stainless steel surfaces not treated as specified.	3.3.5
118	Primer coatings not prepared as specified.	3.4
119	Primer coatings not reduced as specified.	3.4
120	Primer coatings not applied as specified.	3.4
121	Topcoats not prepared as specified.	3.4
122	Topcoats not reduced as specified.	3.5
123	Previously painted surfaces not treated as specified.	3.6
124	Base topcoat not Green 383, 34094 as specified (except for aircraft).	3.8.1
125	Surfaces not requiring paint shall not be painted unless required by the specification for the end item.	3.8.2
126	Engines not cleaned and treated as specified.	3.8.3
127	Sealing not as specified.	3.8.4
128	Electrical components of equipment not otherwise governed by applicable specifications not treated and painted as specified.	3.8.5
129	Steel wool usage not as specified.	3.8.7
130	Welding not as specified.	3.8.8
131	Soldering not as specified.	3.8.8
132	Brazing not as specified.	3.8.8
133	Handling of CARC components not as specified.	3.8.9
134	Storage of CARC components not as specified.	3.8.9

4.2.3 Coating validation. Materials, prior to their use, shall be inspected, sampled and validated to determine compliance with the requirements of the particular specification. However, tests in the material specifications are for the qualification process, and are not necessarily indicative of production performance. All primers and topcoats in the CARC system are QPD items. The one exception is the zinc rich coating complying to A-A-59745, which is also used as a pretreatment

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

on blasted ferrous substrates to replace chromated pretreatments. Certification from the primer or topcoat manufacturer shall include a copy of all quality conformance tests as well as a copy of the Army's validation for the topcoat of the spectral and specular reflectance characteristics of the paint lot when required by the applicable specification. Conformance inspection requirements for epoxy primers MIL-DTL-53022 and MIL-DTL-53030 and any newly published or revised specification, including MIL-PRF-32348 and MIL-DTL-53084, requires the submission from each production lot a batch validation letter detailing the batch number, manufacturer's code, specification and type number, QPL number and batch volume to ARL, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Building 4600, Deer Creek Loop, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5066.

4.2.3.1 Application validation. Whenever there is a change in the type of primer or topcoat, or specification or manufacturer used, application validation testing shall be performed prior to a new coating application to ground support and aviation major end items, such as helicopters and vehicles. This testing is to confirm that any changes in the coating previously used on the military equipment shall not promote adverse affects, which would require removal of the new coating. Testing shall be done on non-production metal exhibiting complex surfaces to determine acceptable application criteria. As specified in the primer or topcoat specification, for spray application, the metal surface area shall be large enough to satisfy all requirements of the spray characteristics. Once the application properties of the new coating are verified and validated, component parts shall be coated and validated before application of the coating to the equipment or the airframe. Once validation is completed, the complete coating system shall be applied to a major end item and approved prior to final acceptance of application procedures.

4.2.3.1.1 Condition of surface. All properly cleaned and pretreated surfaces shall be examined just prior to painting to assure that the surface is dry and free from soil or contamination of any kind. Immediately prior to painting, the surface shall be subjected to a water break test. A mist of distilled water shall be atomized on the surface, employing any convenient small atomizing device. If the water droplets tend to coalesce into large lenses lasting for 25 seconds, (without a sudden flashout), the surface shall be considered as having satisfactorily passed the water break test. If the water gathers into droplets within 25 seconds (if the surface shows a "water break" within that time), the surface shall be considered as having failed the test. If the water forms a continuous film by flashing out suddenly over a large area, this shall be considered evidence of the presence of an impurity on the surface such as free alkali, residual detergent, and the surface shall be considered as having failed the test. Failure to support an unbroken water film shall be sufficient cause to do additional cleaning. If more than four hours have passed since performing the water break test and no pretreatment has been applied, re-examine the surface for corrosion, foreign matter or oily residues and repeat the water break test prior to pretreatment. After testing, all moisture shall be removed to ensure a clean, dry surface for painting. Use cleaning materials effective against the particular type of contaminant causing problems. Multiple cleaning procedures may be required to provide the required water break free surface.

4.2.3.2 Solvent wipe. The solvent wipe test shall be performed to establish that the CARC finish coats are properly prepared and adequately cured to withstand adverse storage. Topcoat solvent wipe test shall be performed after a minimum of 168 hours air drying. If the temperature of the test item drops below 60 ^{o}F (16 ^{o}C), additional time shall be allowed before performing the test. Thoroughly wet a rag with acetone or methyl ethyl ketone (MEK) and briskly rub the painted surface for ten seconds to remove any dry spray or overspray. Wet another clean dry rag

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

with acetone or MEK and briskly rub the same area with 20 strokes approximately six inches (15.24 cm) in length. Evidence of paint removal down to the previous coated surface is evidence of an unacceptably prepared topcoat or an uncured film. These items shall be rejected and reworked in accordance with 3.6 or allowed further cure time and the wipe test repeated. In the latter case, the tested area shall be reworked in accordance with 3.6 to repair any areas of topcoat removal. This test shall be performed in a well ventilated area while wearing gloves to prevent skin contact with the solvents. Contact the installation environmental office for guidance on proper disposal of rags used for the solvent wipe test. This test is also utilized to identify whether a previously coated substrate will accept the CARC coating system. If the previously coated surface fails this solvent wipe test, then the previous coating must be removed to the substrate before the CARC coating system is applied.

4.2.3.3 Dry film thickness (DFT). The upper limits on DFT are not mandatory for surface areas on which such limits are impractical to maintain; for example, contoured areas. However, DFT shall be controlled in these areas, to prevent excessive deposition of paint. Dry film thickness tests shall be performed on uniform coated surfaces. Dry film thickness testing shall be performed using a conventional nondestructive measuring device such as a magnetic tester in accordance with ASTM B499, an eddy current tester in accordance with ASTM B244, or other acceptable standard methods. Dry film thickness requirements for CARC primers and topcoats are listed in table V. Previously applied coatings to the test area shall be identified prior to topcoating, such as repair or rework areas. These previous coatings shall be measured and recorded in sequence to accommodate each progressive coating DFT determination. Unless otherwise specified, rejection shall not be made based solely upon the DFT upper limit of table V, but on subsequent performance failure of another quality assurance provision of section 4. The minimum DFT shall be achieved with each individual coat (i.e., a thin primer coat cannot be “made up for” by a thicker topcoat). The total minimum film thickness shall be maintained and is the cumulative thickness of the current and all subsequent coats (e.g., for a blasted steel substrate painted with a zinc rich coating and subsequently MIL-DTL-53022, the minimum thickness is 3.8 mils). Primer DFT requirements are subject to the manufacturers’ instructions. An excessive primer DFT affects dry and recoat times and ultimately cure times. Adhesion problems occur with excessive primer DFT.

TABLE V. Dry film thickness (mils).

A-A-59745	2.5 – 3.5
MIL-C-8514	0.3 – 0.5
DOD-P-15328	0.3 – 0.5
MIL-PRF-23377	0.8 – 1.2 1/
MIL-DTL-53022	1.3 – 1.7
MIL-DTL-53030	1.3 – 1.7
MIL-PRF-32348	1.8 – 2.2
MIL-DTL-53084	1.0 – 1.2
MIL-PRF-85582	0.8 – 1.2 1/
MIL-DTL-53039	1.8 – 2.5 2/

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE V. Dry film thickness (mils) - Continued.

MIL-DTL-64159	1.8 – 2.5 2/
MIL-PRF-22750	1.7 – 2.3

1/ Except for aircraft, then 0.6-0.9 mils.
2/ Except when using black electrocoat primer, then 2.0-2.5 mils.

TERMS: 1 mil = 25 microns.

4.2.3.4 Marring. Marring and surface lightening due to handling is characteristic of camouflage coatings and does not impede camouflage or the infrared properties of MIL-DTL-53039 or MIL-DTL-64159. This is typical of low gloss and low sheen coatings, and is especially prevalent in dark colors. It is not grounds for re-work unless the film has been damaged down to the previous coat or the substrate.

4.2.3.5 Camouflage requirements and batch validation. Only suppliers approved and listed on the applicable QPD for MIL-DTL-53039 or MIL-DTL-64159 and for MIL-PRF-32348 under type III and type IV coatings are authorized to supply CARC. For every batch manufactured, except for MIL-PRF-32348, type IV, the spectral reflectance, gloss and STB resistance are verified with batch validation by ARL, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Building 4600, Deer Creek Loop, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5066. The paint manufacturer usually initiates the process prior to shipment and results are normally available in four working days. A copy of the certification from ARL shall be made available to inspectors for each batch of paint applied. Slight visual color differences occur between manufacturers or batches yet are not grounds for equipment rejection as long as a batch certification is on hand from ARL and there are no film defects such as blushing or hazing. Improper mixing or application can cause a dry film color that is obviously not as specified. These batch certifications are supplied to the manufacturer on each batch of CARC topcoat that is manufactured.

4.2.3.6 Adhesion. Periodic checks shall be made of the overall adhesion of the CARC system, both primer to substrate and intercoat. Where possible, testing shall be performed daily on a production item or test coupon of the same substrate in an area of uniform film thickness (see 4.2.3.3), after a minimum of 168 hours drying time or force-curing according to the requirements of the applicable specification. Verification of adhesion is considered after a full week of production samples deemed passing. After verification of adhesion, the test frequency shall become weekly. If actual parts are used, the precise location for the adhesion test shall be in an obscure location and be acceptable to the cognizant Government quality assurance representative. The dry adhesion test shall be the default procedure.

4.2.3.6.1 Dry adhesion. Perform the adhesion test in accordance with ASTM D3359, method B, cross cut tape adhesion, using the 6-line pattern and 2 mm (0.079 inch) spacing. Any commercially available tape (1 inch width) that will yield a minimum of 80 oz of adhesive resistance over the tested coating when tested in accordance with ASTM D3330/D3330M shall be used. The assessment of the adhesion of the coating film shall be determined by its ability to not peel when tested in accordance with ASTM D3359. The resultant test rating shall be classified as scale 4B or better. Where CARC dry film thickness has exceeded 7 mils (175 microns), method A of ASTM D3359 shall be used, if permitted by the procuring authority. The

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

resultant test rating, if using method A shall be classified as scale 4A or better. The scribed area shall be repaired in accordance with the procedure established in 3.6.1 and 3.6.2. Rejected items shall be reworked in accordance with 3.6.

4.2.3.6.2 Force dry of CARC topcoat. The drying of CARC topcoats is normally performed at room temperature or force dried in a paint booth at temperatures up to 120 °F (49 °C). Higher temperatures are used when small and component parts are put onto a conveyor line to expedite the process. When CARC topcoats are dried and cured at temperatures of 180 °F (82 °C) or greater, then caution shall be taken to assure that the CARC can be recoated with itself. In cases as this, the CARC topcoat shall first be validated to assure that the higher temperatures do not affect the ability of the coating to be recoated. A representative part or sample panels shall be coated with the CARC system that is used in production and processed through the production line under the same conditions that are used to coat production parts. After the parts or panels have been exposed to the elevated temperatures, they shall be left to sit for 24 hours. They shall then be topcoated with the same CARC topcoat and air dried for 168 hours. Dry tape adhesion tests, as described in 4.2.3.6 and 4.2.3.6.1, shall be performed to check the intercoat adhesion. If the adhesion tests pass, then production shall start with the CARC that was evaluated. This testing shall be done whenever a production line starts up using elevated temperatures of 180 °F (82 °C) or greater to dry, or whenever a change of CARC topcoat is made under the conditions of elevated temperatures for drying.

4.2.3.7 Corrosion resistance. Panels shall be used for preproduction, but for testing end items (hardware) on contracts, actual parts are to be used as well as the accelerated corrosion resistance test specified in TT-C-490. Corrosion resistance is demonstrated on steel specimens (representative 4 x 12 inch (10.16 x 30.48 cm) panels) after application of the primer. The minimum test frequency shall be in accordance with the technical data package or every 30 days, if the test frequency is not specified in the technical data package. Test frequency for enhanced performance primers (1,000 hour salt spray or greater) shall be in accordance with the technical data package or every 60 days if the test frequency is not specified in the technical data package. After complete curing (168 hours at 70 °F (21 °C) or equivalent), the parts or representative panels shall be subjected to a 5 percent salt spray test in accordance with ASTM B117 at 336 hours, or at 1,000 hours, or as specified based upon the specification primer (e.g., MIL-DTL-53022) and type (e.g., I and II) used. If panels are used, coat the edges and uncoated metal surfaces with a suitable coating. Corrosion in excess of a trace of rusting (ASTM D610, No. 9) or more than five scattered blisters, none larger than 1 mm (0.039 in) in diameter visible to the unaided eye on the panel or actual parts shall be cause for rejection. When scribed panels are used, the scribed areas shall have ratings in accordance with ASTM D1654, method A of not less than 6 for steel or 8 for aluminum panels. When cyclic corrosion testing according to GMW 14872 is required, based upon the primer used and requirements of TT-C-490, the panel's evaluated using ASTM D1654 method A shall have a rating of not less than seven (7). Blisters shall cover no more than 5% of the exposed area (rating of 7, ASTM D1654 method B) . Systems of zinc rich primer conforming to A-A-59745 and CARC epoxy primer conforming to either MIL-DTL-53022 or MIL-DTL-53030 shall be tested for corrosion resistance according to the requirements of the CARC epoxy primer being used. Failure at edges and other sharp corners shall not be cause for rejection. Failure to meet the corrosion resistance requirement shall be cause for rejection of parts coated since the previous test period. CARC product formulations are now capable of more vigorous corrosion resistance testing procedures (see 6.5) for a test protocol under consideration.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2.3.7.1 Non-ferrous substrates. Corrosion testing parameters for non-ferrous specimens shall be based upon the requirements specified for aluminum substrates in the appropriately specified primer specification. The frequency of testing shall be as specified in 4.2.3.7. (see 3.8.6).

4.2.3.8 Workmanship. When visually inspected, the coating shall be a smooth, continuous, adherent film which is free of such surface imperfections as runs, sags, blisters, blushing, streaks, craters, blotches, brush marks, fish eyes, seediness or pinholes. Orange peel shall not be criteria for rejection as long as the cured coatings conform to the appropriate dry film thickness, gloss and sheen requirements of the coating specification.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. This section is not applicable to this specification.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The CARC system of primers and topcoats is designed for use on the exterior and interior of tactical military equipment. It may also be used where severe exposure situations require a coating with excellent durability and corrosion resistance.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type of finish as defined in 3.1.
c. When blast cleaning required (see 3.2.1).
d. When wood surfaces will not be pressure treated (see 3.3.4).
e. Color of topcoat if other than those in the 3-color pattern (see 3.5).
f. Camouflage painting and marking of Army materiel conforming to AR 750-1.
g. Reference a NSN.
h. Health and safety issues including facilities, worker safety procedures and equipment, toxic and hazardous waste management, and occupational health requirements.

6.3 Color chips. Color chips for CARC finishes are available from two sources. Chips for the camouflage colors in MIL-DTL-53039 and MIL-DTL-64159 are obtained from ARL, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Building 4600, Deer Creek Loop, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5066, and are intended to be used by paint manufacturers in calibrating their instruments. These calibrated chips from ARL are not intended to be used for visual color inspections, but to assist paint formulators in color development work. Camouflage colors specified in the CARC topcoat specifications have a batch validation requirement and eliminate the need for inspection. If color inspection becomes a concern, request a copy of the batch validation letter. For appearance information only, color chips can be obtained by using the five digit color number of FED-STD-595. The non-camouflage colors found in MIL-DTL-53039, MIL-DTL-64159, MIL-PRF-32348, and MIL-PRF-22750 should match the appropriate color chips from FED-STD-595. These chips can be purchased from the GSA Property Management, GSA/CO/3FPD, 470 L'Enfant Plaza East, SW, Suite 8100, Washington, DC 20407.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.4 Qualifying activity responsibility. The qualifying activity responsible for MIL-PRF-23377, MIL-PRF-85582, and MIL-DTL-5541 is the Commander, Naval Air Systems Command, Systems Standardization Division, Code 4L8000B120-3, Highway 547, Lakehurst, NJ 08733-5100. The qualifying activity responsible for MIL-DTL-53022, MIL-DTL-53030, MIL-DTL-53084, A-A-59745, MIL-PRF-32348, MIL-PRF-22750, MIL-DTL-53039, MIL-DTL-64159, and TT-C-490 is ARL, Weapons and Materials Research Directorate, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5066.

6.5 Experimental program. ARL conducts an Experimental Products Program (EPP) to evaluate performance-based alternatives to specification products. These materials generally offer benefits such as environmental acceptability or improved performance that is not currently available in the specification. These products may be used prior to appearing on the applicable QPD with approval from the appropriate program office. These products will be issued an EPP approval letter prior to being included into an appropriate QPD. Subsequent revision of the specification allows the EPP products to be converted to normal QPD listings. Confirmation of EPP approval can be obtained from ARL, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Building 4600, Deer Creek Loop, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5066.

6.6 Coating characteristics. The coatings and their characteristics are listed in the following table.

TABLE VI. Coating characteristics.

Specification	Primer Category		Toxic Metals	VOC Category		
	Pre-treated ferrous	Pre-treated non-ferrous	Lead and chromate free	Federal 3.5 lbs/gal (420 g/l)	SCAQMD Rule 1124 2.9 lbs/gal (348 g/l)	SCAQMD Rule 1107 2.8 lbs/gal (340 g/l)
MIL-PRF-23377		X	class N 1/	X	X	X
MIL-DTL-53022	X	X	X	X	X	X
MIL-DTL-53030	X	X	X	X	X	X
MIL-DTL-53084	X	X	X	X	X	X
MIL-PRF-85582		X	class N 1/	X	X	X
A-A-59745	X		X	X	X	X
MIL-PRF-32348	X	X	X	X	X	X
MIL-PRF-22750	N/A	N/A	X	X	X	X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE VI. Coating characteristics. – Continued.

MIL-DTL-53039	N/A	N/A	X	X	X	X
MIL-DTL-64159	N/A	N/A	X	X	X	X

1/ In accordance with Memorandum, AMSAM-EN-EV, 29 January 2009, Subject: Implementation of Non-Hexavalent Chromium Coating System on Army Aircraft, class N (type I or II) is approved for use as a primer on Army Aviation Systems exterior mold lines. Use of class N primers for interior applications must be approved by the item Program Manager or cognizant engineering authority. The type II is only approved as a CARC primer on aviation assets.

6.7 Touch-up kits. Only authorized and approved touch-up kits are allowed for the repair, touch-up or stenciling of existing CARC coatings. These are supplied in various forms and are approved with QPD numbers by ARL. For further information, contact ARL, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Building 4600, Deer Creek Loop, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5066. Spray cans that are designed specifically for a color match and not previously approved by ARL cannot be used.

6.8 New heavy metal-free pretreatments. Novel corrosion inhibitors, pretreatments, primers and topcoats are being developed and evaluated as alternatives to zinc phosphate, chromate conversion coatings and wash primers for inclusion in the CARC system. For further information on products being tested and approved, contact ARL, ATTN: RDRL-WMM-C, Organic Coatings Team, Building 4600, Deer Creek Loop, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5066 or the contracting agency.

6.9 HAP-free solvent specification. The following is the specification requirements for the new HAP-free thinner to be used as an alternative to MIL-T-81772, types I and II.

HAP Free CARC Solvent

Composition	CAS	Percent by Weight
T-Butyl Acetate	540-88-5	73-77 %
Methyl Amyl Ketone	110-43-0	23-27 %

Quantitative Requirements:

Maximum Water Content (percent by weight): 0.02%.

Maximum Alcohol Content (percent by weight): 0.04%.

Maximum Nonvolatile Content (grams/100ml): 0.02 (0.0017 lbs/gal).

Minimum Flash Point: 40°F (4°C).

Density (lbs/gallon): 6.9 - 7.2 (827-863 g/l).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Appearance: The appearance of the solvent shall be clear and free from suspended matter when examined by transmitted light.

Odor: The odor shall be characterized of the ingredients and not noticeable after drying on the filter paper.

Spot Test: The solvent shall leave no oily spot or stain on filter paper.

Composition: The composition shall conform to the amounts given above.

APHA Color: Maximum 10.

Acidity: Maximum 0.01 percent by weight.

Reclaim material: The use of reclaimed solvent is prohibited.

Compatibility: Must be compatible when mixed 4:1 by volume with MIL-DTL-53022E and MIL-DTL-53039D.

Certificate of conformance and analysis: Submitted with each shipment.

6.10 Subject term (key word) listing.

Aircraft
Equipment
Guide
Powder
Pretreatments
Primer
Surfaces
Thinner
Topcoat

6.11 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identity changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Custodians:
Army - MR
Navy - SH
Air Force - 11

Review activities:
Army - MD1, MI, AV
Navy - AS, CG, MC
Air Force - 84, 99

Civil agency:
GSA/FAS

Preparing activity:
Army - MR

(Project 8010-2012-006)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil/.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T21:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.